

Literature

Plays
Poetry Reading
General Lit.
History of Lit





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): General Lit.: Grades 11-12, History of Lit: Grades 9-12, Plays: Grades 9-12, Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

About Plays: Grades 9-12

Students read Shakespeare's plays with additional optional readings and extra helpings from the time period.

About Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

About General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Journey into the 19th century via novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from and about the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

About History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Using Marshall's and Long's spines along with a variety of primary sources and additional readings, the History of Literature course introduces students to literary movements and figures in the 19th century. The course prioritizes influential texts in the English-speaking world but also seeks to give students glimpses of literary developments across the globe.

Plays: Grades 9-12

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

Literature: Grade 12

Some books shared with other High School grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.

Plays: Grades 9-12

This year, this course is the same as Shakespeare for Grades 5-8 with the only difference coming in Extra Helpings and additional options for further study.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Some books shared with other high school grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Lessons are shared across high school grades with grade-specific assignments in the lesson plans as appropriate.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Plays: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	The Tempest The Tempest (Audio recording) Henry IV Part 2 Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording) The Winter's Tale The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon
11-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 2 times/week 30 min	Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass Up from Slavery James Jane Eyre The Count of Monte Cristo Short stories and other writings Things Fall Apart The Souls of Black Folk
9-12	History of Lit: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	History of Literature PDF American Literature English Literature for Boys and Girls

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book Echoes of Eden – Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

☐ Jane Eyre (Term 2: Option 1) This novel touches on difficult themes, including a child in an unhappy home situation, loss, a romantic relationship with a significant secret, mental illness, and questions of faith and duty. Teachers may wish to preview these elements before assigning.

☐ James (Term 2: Option 2) This novel is recommended for mature students, as it includes strong language, racial slurs and stereotypes, and graphic scenes of violence and abuse, mainly directed towards the enslaved characters in the novel. These scenes intensify toward the end of the novel. Pre-reading or familiarizing yourself with the content to determine suitability for your student(s) is encouraged. Frankenstein or Silas Marner from General Lit.: Grades 9-10 are also possible alternatives.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

☐ Print off the History of Literature PDF, as students will need to annotate and mark up various sections throughout the year.

☐ Although sources were condensed into one PDF when possible, there are still quite a few outside links due to the number of primary sources referenced, so make sure your student(s) has/have access to the internet for their course.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grade 12

Plays: Grades 9-12



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon

General Lit.: Grades 11-12



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Up from Slavery



James



Jane Eyre



The Count of Monte Cristo

Short stories and other writings



Things Fall Apart



The Souls of Black Folk

History of Lit: Grades 9-12



History of Literature PDF



American Literature



English Literature for Boys and Girls



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grade 12

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12

∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grade 12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Introduction - Romanticism

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

What authors and books come to mind when you think about literature in 19th century? You may be familiar with terms such as the "Romantic period" or "Victorian period." Tell or jot down anything that comes to mind.

Over the year we'll learn about the lives and writings of people who wrote from about 1800-1900 AD. These individuals wrote in a wide array of genres: poetry, essays, short stories, plays, science fiction, mysteries, thrillers, children's stories, and more. When possible, the readings scheduled in History of Lit will align with what you are reading in your Poetry and General Literature courses.

We'll focus on authors who wrote in English but will also spend some time getting a taste for influential texts written in other languages as well. Every culture has significant texts and stories, so while we're limited in this course to English texts and texts translated into English, it's important to remember there is a world of books and literary traditions from cultures around the world which we don't have the time or often the language to read in this course!

English writings from the end of the 18th century into the first half of the 19th century are sometimes grouped together as part of the "Romantic Period." As with any generalization, this is a label scholars have put on the time frame as they look back, not something authors were so much thinking about consciously as they wrote, although as we will see, writers and poets from this period were often aware that their style of writing was something new.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Romantic Period" p.1-7

- What are some of the themes to look out for when you read literature from the Romantic Period? How did Romantic writers break with the traditions of Classicism? Do you recognize any ideas about poets and poetry in this reading that are still current today? How would you say our time is different or similar? What "rules" define literature written in English today?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: The Shrubbery

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees



Term 1

around him?

∞ Link: To a Mouse

- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud.
- This poem ends with a turn. Why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ INTRO

Alexandre Dumas's *The Count of Monte Cristo* is a well-loved story of betrayal, revenge, and redemption. It was originally written as a serial, so as you read, imagine the experience of the first readers who were continuously given cliff hangers and had to wait for the next installment of the plot!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Plan to read for about 20 minutes each week and leave 10 minutes for narration and discussion. The edition chosen for this course is the abridged version, but it is still too long to cover in two terms just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time. Or just read 20 minutes each week, and if you are interested, you can finish the book after the end of the term.

- There are a lot of characters in this novel! Begin a character list today, and jot down a few details. What kind of man is Edmond Dantès at the opening of the novel?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read who use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, which had a very rigid structure?

→ READ

∞ Link: Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey, painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

∞ Art Link: Tintern Abbey

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: Douglass's Narrative contains several graphic descriptions of beatings and racial slurs.



Term 1

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography that details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer."

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading?
- What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

Today, we begin reading the autobiography of Booker T. Washington. It was first written as a periodical, but was later put into book form. Washington was born a slave, but was still a child when emancipation occurred. He later founded Tuskegee Institute in Alabama and spent his life advancing the cause of equal rights. His writings give a window into the Reconstruction period that followed the American Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.1-11 "I was born" - "owners as to the future."

- How does Washington describe his childhood? How does he describe the day of emancipation?

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Tempest

PREP: Read an overview of the play (one synopsis is located at the beginning of the Folger edition of the play). If you are not familiar with the play, you will want to read other retellings. We highly suggest Stories from Shakespeare by Marchette Chute. Resources are listed on the Extra Helpings Page. Also, be sure to read the note about mature content and language in Shakespeare in the Planning and Prep section.

→ INTRO

- What makes a tragedy a tragedy or a comedy a comedy?
 - Our play this term is sometimes called a tragicomedy because it has both comedic and tragic elements. Overall, the play has a happy ending, which places it in the comedic category. The name of the play 'Tempest' means "a violent storm," and it will give us lots of things to ponder about power, betrayal, magic, slavery, and the restoration of relationships.
 - Take time to review the elements of tragedy and comedy before beginning.
- ∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1: Scene 1-2 p.7-25 "Boatswain!" - "Approach, my Ariel. Come."

- How does each character respond to the storm? What is the tone of this scene?
- Re-read lines 84-95. Discuss the context this gives for the story.
- Put the following quote from Miranda into your own words. What does it

★ TEACHER TIP

Take turns reading the play aloud if using these lessons in a group. We recommend reading the summaries of each scene to briefly preview content and help orient students.



Term 1

tell us about what Miranda is like?

"A brave vessel,
Who had, no doubt, some noble creature in her,
Dashed all to pieces. O, the cry did knock
Against my very heart! Poor souls, they perished.
Had I been any god of power, I would
Have sunk the sea within the earth or ere
It should the good ship so have swallowed, and
The fraughting souls within her."

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2 *William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge*

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the major themes of the Romantic Period from last week's reading?

→ INTRO

Today, we will learn more about the life and work of two poets - William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge, who are most closely associated with English Romantic poetry.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Marshall, Ch.LXXIV "Wordsworth - the Poet of Nature."
 - How did Wordsworth's experiences as a child seem to influence his later poetry?
2. Marshall, Ch.LXXV "Wordsworth and Coleridge - the Lake Poets."
 - What are some similarities and differences between the two poets?

• IMPORTANT DATES William Wordsworth (1770-1850)

Samuel Taylor Coleridge (1772-1834)

First publication of the Lyrical Ballads (1798)

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3 *William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge*

→ INTRO

With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their Lyrical Ballads, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)
2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"
My heart leaps up when I behold
A rainbow in the sky:
So was it when my life began;
So is it now I am a man;
So be it when I shall grow old,
Or let me die!
The Child is father of the Man;
And I could wish my days to be
Bound each to each by natural piety.
3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"
4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think has happened at the party?
- Describe the character of Mercédès and continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

Today, we are going to read a poem that is very different in style from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

→ READ

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of The Rime of the Ancient Mariner.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.11-22 "After the coming of freedom" - "or a handkerchief."

- Why were names so important to Washington and the other newly freed people?
- How does Washington describe the conditions of formerly enslaved people immediately after emancipation?
- How is education described in this chapter? Why did Washington see it as so important?



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

How did Prospero and Miranda come to be on the island?

→ INTRO

The Tempest explores the theme of power, and we see this in Prospero's relationships. Watch a portion of Act 1, Scene 2, to learn more about Prospero's relationship to Ariel.

∞ Video Link: Act 1, Scene 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.25-39 "All hail, great master!" - "So, slave, hence."

- How would you describe Prospero's relationship with Caliban and Ariel?
- Put this quote by Caliban into your own words: "This island's mine by Sycorax, my mother, Which thou tak'st from me."

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Rabindranath Tagore

→ INTRO

If you are taking the Poetry Reading course this year, you will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher, and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

→ VIEW, NARRATE & DISCUSS

This video provides an excellent overview of Tagore's life and work. It will take nearly the entire lesson time to watch, although you can watch at 1.25x speed.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

- What were some of Tagore's major contributions to arts and history?

→ READ

∞ Link: The Gardener 85

This short poem is a timely piece to read, since Tagore was still alive and writing a century ago.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941)

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher, and artist Rabindranath Tagore, who was born in 1861 in Calcutta, India, and grew up in a family that loved art, music, and ideas. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century. In 1913, he became the first non-European writer to be awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature. He also composed the national anthems for both India and Bangladesh, making his words a lasting part of two nations.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are not taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate



Term 1

as childhood wonder, the natural world, and imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's *A Child's Garden of Verses*.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

- How would you describe the speaker of this poem?
- The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think of the character of Villefort? What is his secret?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.11-16

p.12-13 "Sleep-Stealer"

- Do you think someone really stole the baby's sleep?
- What phrase is repeated throughout the poem? Why do you think this is?
- How does the poem blur the line between the real world and the imaginative world?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)



Term 1

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
 - Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.22-34 "Finally, the great day came" - "get through the school year."

- What hardships does he encounter while traveling, and how does he respond to them? Where does he find the strength to persevere?
- Describe Mrs. Ruffner and how she impacted his life. Who else had an impact on Washington?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Think back on what you learned about Ariel and Caliban through Prospero's conversations with and about them. What is your opinion of Prospero at this point?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.41-49 "Come unto these" - "Speak not for him."

- What does Ferdinand think of Miranda? How do you think this relationship will develop or change?

→ ACTIVITY

With the remaining time, let's dig into Caliban's speech from earlier in this scene to work to stretch our imaginations and seek to understand his world from his perspective as well as Prospero's.

∞ Link: Caliban Visual

★ TEACHER NOTE

The activity at the end of the lesson requires you to be present. Also, there are more layers to the activity than will likely fit in the remaining time after the reading is done. The point is to practice seeing the play from a different perspective, so feel free to stop at the end of the lesson time and move on or continue the activity if desired and time allows.

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Sir Walter Scott

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

E.M. Forster described Sir Walter Scott as a writer "over whom we shall violently divide," and certainly he has had his share of ardent readers and detractors. But one reason his works are still appreciated, as the literary critic Walter Allen said, is that "without being in the strict sense a historian, he revolutionized the writing of history." Today we will learn more about this author whom Virginia Woolf described as "perhaps the last novelist to practice the great, the Shakespearean art, of making people reveal themselves in speech," and of whom Jane Austen said, "Walter Scott has no business to write novels, especially good ones. It is not fair. He has Fame and Profit enough as a Poet!"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS



Term 1

Ch.LXXVII "Scott - The Awakening of Romance
Ch.LXXVIII "Scott - 'The Wizard of the North'"

- What elements of Scott's subject matter and style seem distinctive to you?

→ **READ**

∞ Link: Lochinvar

WEEK 4 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

□ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ **RECAP**

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ **READ & DISCUSS**

p.17-22

p.19 "Playthings"

- How does the poem compare a child's play to adult work, and which seems more satisfying?
- What "art" has the adult forgotten?
- What does the poem mean when it says adults spend their lives seeking "costly playthings"? Does this create success and happiness?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 7

□ Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ **RECAP**

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What is the political situation in France as the action of the novel begins?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 4 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

□ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ **RECAP**

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ **READ & DISCUSS**

p.23-29

p.23-24 "Fairyland"

- Why do you think the child whispers the secret to the mother instead of telling everyone?
- In what ways can imagination transform ordinary places into something wondrous and special?

p.28-29 "Paper Boats"

- What is inside the boat during the poem?
- What do you think the child imagines will happen to the paper boats on



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their journey?

- Why do you think the child hopes that "someone in some strange land" will find the boats?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ **VIEW**

∞ Picture Link: Tulsi plant

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 8

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ **RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)**

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.19-26 "But alas!" - "learning how to write."

- How did Douglass's experiences with the Aulds set him "on the pathway from slavery to freedom"? Why did Mr. Auld forbid his wife to teach Douglass to read, and what did Douglass learn from this about literacy?
- How does Douglass teach himself to read and write? What obstacles does he face, and what does he learn about his own situation from what he reads?

→ **RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)**

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.4-6 p.34-50 "Three weeks before" - "features of the institution."

- Why does he believe education should include both academic learning and practical skills? How does Washington begin helping other members of his community?
- What opportunities and challenges arose for formerly enslaved people during the Reconstruction period? What aspects is Washington most critical of?
- What does Washington learn from his experience working with Native Americans?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: The Tempest

→ **RECAP**

What is the setting (background story and situation) of The Tempest?

→ **INTRO**

The setting of The Tempest is unique. The play takes place on a remote island (meaning no one lives there) with the exception of Caliban and Ariel. This island is in the Mediterranean Sea. However, there are two important Italian Kingdoms mentioned – Naples and Milan. Prospero and Miranda, as well as the characters who crashed on the island, are from these kingdoms. Let's review the map and the character list. Consider sketching a map in your notebook.

∞ Map Link: Tempest and Kingdoms

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**



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Act 2 Scene 1 p.53-65 "Beseech you, sir" - "Go sleep, and hear us."

- What does this scene show about the characters of Antonio and Sebastian? How does it compare to Alonso's behavior?

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Percy Bysshe Shelley

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Sir Walter Scott from last week?

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley, the husband of Mary Shelley (the author of *Frankenstein*). If you are also taking the Poetry course, you will read some of his poetry this week. However, today you will also read an excerpt from his *Defence of Poetry*, a philosophical essay on the nature and function of poets and poetry.

Do you recall any details about Shelley from the overview of the Romantic Period you read in Week 1?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Percy Bysshe Shelley Biography

2. *Defence of Poetry*

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.8-13

- What are the main points Shelley is making in this excerpt? What images and arguments stand out to you the most? What do you think he means by "poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world?"

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare and contrast what you read of Shelley's *Defence to the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads*.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.30-35

p.33-34 "The Merchant"

- What gifts would you bring home if you traveled to magical lands like the child in the poem?
- What do the different gifts chosen for the mother, father, and brother reveal about how the child sees each person?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Shiuli flower (The English name is night-blooming jasmine.)

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.



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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What is Dantès's life like as a prisoner? How has he spent the years of his imprisonment so far?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 5 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Percy Bysshe Shelley

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets we will read this term: Percy Bysshe Shelley. While he was inspired by the work and thought of Wordsworth and Coleridge, he has a style all his own. Look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The first two poems are sonnets. What do you already know about sonnets? How does the form support the meaning of the poem? Both these poems have guides, if you would like to read about them further.
 - ∞ Link: Ozymandias
 - ∞ Link: England in 1819
 - What do you know about what was happening in English around the year 1819?

2. In these second two poems, consider how Shelley is representing nature.

∞ Link: Ode to the West Wind

∞ Link: Mont Blanc

- What poetic images stand out to you the most?

WEEK 5 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 10

□ Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-33 "In a very short time" - "sagacity to see it."

- What was Douglass's and the other slaves' situation when his master, Captain Anthony, died? How does Douglass's direct description of valuation strengthen his argument against slavery?
- What is Douglass's life like once he lives with Thomas Auld?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.51-64 "During the time" - "deeply as this one."

- What challenges did Washington face when he went to Tuskegee? What do we learn about his leadership style from how he faced these difficulties?
- Why does Washington praise manual labor so highly? What episodes from his younger years influenced the importance he placed on this type of work?



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WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Explain the reason for King Alonso's having sailed from Tunis. What does he think of ever setting out for Tunis in the first place?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 1 p.65-75 "What, all soon" - "to seek thy son."

- How would you describe Alonso and Antonio's relationship?

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Percy Bysshe Shelley from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This article is fairly long. You may skim through the information about her early life with Percy Shelley, but be sure to read the excerpts of her travel writing and other prose towards the end of the article.

∞ Article Link: Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley Biography

- What aspects of Mary Shelley's character are evident in her writing? If you are reading Frankenstein this year, does knowing more about the author's life affect your reading of her work?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, *cont.*

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Shelley that you read in the last lesson? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.36-40

p.36 "Vocation"

- Why does the child think the hawker, gardener, and watchman have exciting lives?
- How does the poem contrast school life with the child's longing for independence?
- What does the poem suggest about our tendency to imagine that other lives are freer or happier than our own?

p.40 "Authorship"

- Did you catch the line about the child making a paper boat? Do you think this is the same child who made paper boats in a previous poem?
- What kinds of stories does the child wish the father would write?
- How does the poem show the difference between the way children and adults value work, play, and creativity?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?



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WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Which characters do you trust? Which ones are you suspicious of? Jot down some initial impressions, and it will be interesting for you to refer back to them as you get further into the novel.
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

John Keats

→ INTRO

Today, we will meet the second of the second-generation Romantic poets: John Keats. As we did with Shelley, look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period. There is only one poem to read today, because your understanding and appreciation of it will increase with multiple readings. Read it through more than once on your own, and if you would like some interpretive help, there is a link to a guide to the poem.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This poem, Ode on a Grecian Urn, is a famous example of ekphrasis, which means the poetic description of a work of art. As you read, think about how the poetry engages with other arts, such as sculpture and music. What does it have to say about the limits of any one art form, or, put more bluntly, what can poetry do that sculpture can't, and vice versa?
∞ Link: Ode on a Grecian Urn

- The final enigmatic two lines have been an interpretive puzzle since Keats wrote this poem. What do you think he means by "Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know." And why are they in quotation marks? Because the manuscript is unclear, sometimes the closing quotation mark is placed after "truth beauty." How might that change the meaning?

∞ Link: Poem Guide: Ode on a Grecian Urn

→ VIEW

It is helpful to have an image of what Keats is describing when reading the poem.
∞ Link: Sketch of an Urn by Keats

• COMPOSITION - Poetry

Think of a piece of art you have really loved in Picture Study. With an image of the art in front of you, start writing your own ekphrastic poem about it. Include any notes about why you chose to write it the way you did. Work to keep your chosen meter/rhyme scheme consistent.

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 12

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-39 "While I lived with my master" - "myself to my wretched lot."

- Why does Douglass call Edward Covey a "slave breaker"? What

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content in a quotation: Up From Slavery p.68.



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methods does Covey use to control enslaved people?

- How does Douglass describe the physical and emotional effects of his time with Covey?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.64-74 "The coming of Christmas" - "or perhaps could build."

- How did the community support the school in Tuskegee?
- Why is it important for Washington to teach his students to "love work for its own sake" (72)?
- What lesson did Washington learn from brick-making about racial relations?

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What does Antonio propose that Sebastian do? How is this proposal similar to Antonio's actions towards his brother, Prospero?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 2 p.77-87 "All the infections" - "Lead the way."

- What is loyalty? How does loyalty motivate characters?

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

John Keats

Materials: English Literature for Boys and Girls

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXI "Keats - The Poet of Beauty"

- What are some connections between Keats and other writers you have studied this term? Which excerpts of his writing did you enjoy the most in today's reading?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.41-46

p.49 "The Banyan Tree". The Banyan tree is the national tree of India.

- Why do you think the child wants to be the wind, a bird, or a duck?
- How does the poem show movement through the images?
- What might the child learn from quietly watching nature every day?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Parable of the Banyan Tree



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Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
 • What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 13

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- How would you describe the character of Faria? What is his secret? What role does he play in Dantès's life?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

John Keats, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Link: Ode to a Nightingale
 - What does the nightingale represent to Keats in this poem?
2. The other two poems by Keats are both sonnets written in response to other works of art. The first he wrote after reading George Chapman's translation of Homer, and the second in response to the Elgin Marbles (statuaries from the Parthenon) when they were first displayed at the British Museum.
 - ∞ Link: On First Looking into Chapman's Homer
 - ∞ Link: On Seeing the Elgin Marbles

→ VIEW

A slide show of the sculptures that Keats would have seen.
 ∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles at the British Library

• EXTRA HELPING

The Elgin Marbles are controversial, and Greece has requested their repatriation. Read more about the controversy here.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 14

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-45 "I have already intimated" - "practice is a very common one."

- Why do you think Douglass describes "this battle with Mr. Covey [as] the turning point in my career as a slave"?
 - How does Douglass describe the celebration of Christmas for slaves as a tool of control rather than genuine kindness? How does this description support his anti-slavery argument?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.74-85 "The same principle" - "button is to be found missing."

- What challenges did Washington continue to face in setting up Tuskegee? How did he face them, and what can you learn from his perseverance?
- What were some lessons that Washington was trying to teach the students beyond the classroom?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Describe Trinculo's account of his meeting Caliban.

→ INTRO

Act 3, Scene 2 highlights a lot of the conflict in The Tempest. Pay attention to how Caliban and Ariel both use deception for different purposes.

→ READ & NARRATE

Act 3 Scene 1-2 p.91-109 "There be some" - "I'll follow, Stephano."

→ DISCUSS

Pretend you are an investigative reporter covering Caliban's plot to overthrow Prospero in Act 3, Scene 2. Look back at the scene and see what evidence you can find to explain the conspiracy to the public. Use these questions to guide you:

1. What is Caliban's plan?
2. Why does Caliban want Stephano to rule the island?
3. How does Ariel disrupt the plan and cause confusion?
4. Is Stephano a strong leader? Does he do anything to suggest he isn't?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students watch a portion of Act 3, Scene 2.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 2

- COMPOSITION - News Report
Build on the discussion from the lesson and create a news report. If you are doing these lessons alone, write up your findings as a news article. If you can pull in some family members or classmates, work together to plan out and present either a live broadcast (have a host interview several news reporters on the island) or even an interview show (have a host interview the characters of Caliban, Stephano, Trinculo, and Ariel in a heated discussion).

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

→ INTRO

Today, we will learn about a Romantic poet from another part of the world - Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda - who was born in Cuba and lived in Spain. She is the subject of The Lightning Dreamer, a biographical story told through poems, which you will start reading this week if you are taking the Poetry Reading 9-12 course.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

- What aspects of her life made it difficult for her to be a poet? What aspects made it easier for her to be a poet than other women during this time period?
- The article describes her as "the epitome of the Romantic poet, the tragic heroine who rises to public acclaim yet, in private, is bitterly unhappy," which is a quotation from the preface to a 2001 edition of her novel Sab. Are there other Romantic poets you've learned about so far this term that you would describe the same way?
- What questions do you have about Avellaneda's life and work?

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: 10 Poems by Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to a recitation of "To a Butterfly"

∞ Video Link: To A Butterfly by Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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- What are your first impressions of her poetry? What subjects does she choose to write about?
- Do her poems remind you of anything else you've read?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ INTRO

Today, we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873), who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.169-174 "Historical Note"

p.ix "Historical Background"

p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other? Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: What is free verse?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- How does Dantès escape? How does he use the lessons he learned from Faria in prison to aid his plan?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has his death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other? Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.



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WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 16

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-52 "On the first of January" - "we succeeded very well."

- How does this section show the hypocrisy between the slave-holders' professions of Christianity and their actions?
 - How does Douglass describe his time with Mr. Freeland?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: UP FROM SLAVERY)

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

(We are skipping chapters 12-13.)

Ch.14 p.105-115 "The Atlanta Exposition" - "exact justice to both races."

- What does Washington mean by "Cast down your bucket where you are"?
- How would you describe the overall message of his speech? How was it received?

→ LISTEN

The only audio recording of Booker T. Washington in existence is him reading the opening paragraphs of his Atlanta Exposition Speech in 1905.
∞ Audio Link: Booker T. Washington's "Atlanta Compromise" Speech

→ WATCH

This short biography of Booker T. Washington also introduces the debate with W. E. B. Du Bois, which will be the focus of the next three lessons.
∞ Video Link: Booker T. Washington: Founder of Tuskegee University & Champion for Civil Rights

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What plan does Caliban propose to Stephano?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 1 p.109-125 "By 'r lakin" - "All eyes. Be Silent."

- What is the purpose of the magical banquet? How do people respond to the banquet?

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

José María Heredia

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda's life and poetry?

→ INTRO

As a child in Cuba, Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda was tutored by the



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Cuban Romantic poet José María Heredia. Today, we will learn more about him and read two selections of his poetry. If you are reading *The Lightning Dreamer*, you will discover just how much influence Heredia had on Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda's development as a writer and thinker.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of José María Heredia

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Niagara

∞ Link: The Hurricane

- How would you describe the mood of these poems?
- What do Niagara Falls and The Hurricane symbolize in these poems?
- Do these poems remind you of any others you have read this year?

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

📖 Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

How would you describe this book (so far) to someone who had never read it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-35

- How do the decisions Tula's mother made differ from what she expects from Tula? What is your impression of her mother so far?
- Why does Tula feel she can free herself "only with words"?
- Why is Tula not allowed to read books? What are her mother and stepfather afraid of happening if she reads books?

WEEK 9 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 17

📖 Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think Dantès will do once he is free?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 9 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

📖 Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.47-50

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?



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WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore."

- What is Douglass's plan to escape to freedom? What happens?
- How does Douglass's experience working at the shipyard demonstrate the injustices of the law?

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

W. E. B. Du Bois was a prominent writer, sociologist, historian, and advocate for civil rights. He was raised in Massachusetts and attended Fisk University and then Harvard, where he became the first African American to receive a PhD. He devoted his life to working for full equality for African Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "The Forethought" & Chapter 1: Of Our Spiritual Strivings

- Compare his aims and writing style to Washington's: what are some similarities and differences?
- Du Bois introduces two significant metaphors in today's reading: his concept of the "Veil" and of "double consciousness." How would you explain them to someone?

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Recall the conversation Prospero has with Ferdinand about his daughter, Miranda. What is your opinion of him as a father?

→ INTRO

This scene has a famous monologue with the phrase, "Our revels now are ended." Let's take some time to watch the clip before reading the scene.

∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 1 p.125-141 "Ceres, most bounteous" - "do me service."

- Prospero deals with a lot of inner conflict (conflict within himself). How do we see Prospero resolving these inner conflicts?

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Felicia Dorothea Hemans

→ RECAP

Which of the two poems by Heredia that you read last week did you prefer?

→ INTRO

We're jumping back in time by a few decades today to meet Felicia Dorothea Hemans, an English Romantic poet who was wildly popular in



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her own day. She was read and admired by many poets you have been reading so far this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of Felicia Dorothea Hemans

- Writing allowed Hemans to provide for herself and her five sons after her husband abandoned her, but what were some ways that the challenges she faced negatively impacted her writing?
- Do you see any similarities in the biographies of Felicia Hemans and Mary Shelley?

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: To Wordsworth

∞ Link: The Haunted House

∞ Link: Casabianca

- How would you describe the style of these poems? Do they remind you of other works you've read so far this year?
- The poem Casabianca, with its tragic pathos, was a poem that almost took on a life of its own upon publication, being often imitated and (later on) parodied. What do you think it was about this poem that made it so popular?

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Lightning Dreamer

☐ Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What did we learn about Tula's situation in the last chapter? What does her future hold?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-55

- What have we learned about Caridad and why she might not want to share stories of her childhood?
- What need does the orphan theater fill for Tula? Why does she have to change the stories her plays tell?

WEEK 10 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 19

☐ Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What role does faith play in Dantès's story?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 10 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?



Term 1

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.51-54

p.54 "The Last Bargain"

- Why do you think the child chooses the child instead of the king, the old man, or the fair maiden?
- What do you think the speaker discovers about freedom by the end of the poem?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ LISTEN

Tagore's words became the basis for both India's and Bangladesh's national anthems. You can listen to them here with an English translation.

∞ Music Link: Jana Gana Mana - India National Anthem English lyrics

∞ Music Link: "Amar Shonar Bangla" - Bangladesh National Anthem Bangla & English lyrics

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 20

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.58-63 "Master Hugh, finding he could" - "for the reasons before mentioned."

- Why doesn't Douglass provide more details about how he escaped?
- What does it mean for Douglass to "hire his time," and how does this practice reinforce the injustices of slavery?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

What do you recall from your reading last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-25 Chapter 3: Of Booker T. Washington and Others

- How does Du Bois describe Washington's life and work?
- What are some of his critiques of the "Atlanta Compromise" and Washington's priorities?
- Compare the two men's views on education: what kinds of education do they each advocate?

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more background on Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois's differing views, the following overview from Yale's Teachers Institute is helpful if your students have additional questions.

∞ Link: Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois: The Problem of Negro Leadership

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Think back on what wishes Juno and Ceres bestow upon Ferdinand and Miranda at the masque. Reference Act 4 Scene 1 L119-130. What other blessings would you add if you were at their engagement party?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.145-157 "Now does my project" - "me my dukedom."

- Why does Prospero choose to forgive his enemies instead of seeking revenge? What does this say about his character?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students watch a portion of Act 5, Scene 1. As students near the end of the play, have them consider concepts and characters that have run throughout. Use this fun, interactive activity from the Royal Shakespeare Company to get them thinking about these concepts.

∞ Video Link: Act 5, Scene 1

∞ Link: Tempest Shapes

Literature: Grade 12

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Term 1

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Thomas Carlyle

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the life and work of Felicia Hemans from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXII "Carlyle - The Sage of Chelsea"

- Marshall writes that Carlyle "was a great historian, but in the history he gives us not dead facts, but living, breathing men and women. His pages are as full of color and of life as the pages of Shakespeare." What history books have you read that could be described that way? Why is it such a praiseworthy feature of history writing?
- What do you notice about Carlyle's style in the passages quoted in today's reading?

- **COMPOSITION - Descriptive**
Write a character sketch of Thomas Carlyle based on Marshall's chapter.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore that you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Fireflies is a collection of small poems, thoughts, and sayings that Tagore published in 1928. It contains the famous line "The butterfly counts not months but moments, and has time enough." Spend 10 minutes reading through this book (you are not expected to read the whole thing, just skim through the pages), and try composing a few of your own in the same style (you'll have more time to do this in a composition class).

∞ PDF Link: Fireflies

- **COMPOSITION - Poetry**
Try to compose a few short poems in the style of Fireflies.

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 21

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Why do you think Caderousse was Dantès's first stop? What can Dantès do in disguise that he wouldn't be able to do if he revealed his true self to his former friends and acquaintances?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Catch-up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.



Term 1

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 22

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-69 "I have been frequently asked" - "with my labors to decide."

- How does Douglass describe the feeling of finally being free?
- What circumstances prompt him to begin speaking and working as an abolitionist?

→ VIEW

Learn more about Frederick Douglass's later life.

∞ Video Link: Frederick Douglass: First African American Nominated for Vice President

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: THE SOULS OF BLACK FOLK)

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-36 Chapter 5: Of the Wings of Atalanta

- Why does Du Bois draw on the myth of Atalanta and the golden apples in this chapter?
- At the end of this chapter, he writes: "We are training not isolated men but a living group of men,—nay, a group within a group. And the final product of our training must be neither a psychologist nor a brickmason, but a man" (36). Can you explain what he means in your own words? What does this argument tell us about how he views the purpose of education?

• COMPOSITION

What passages in either Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass or Up From Slavery illustrated the importance of education and literacy? Jot down your initial thoughts, then look back at the book and read or skim sections to discover relevant passages or ideas you might have forgotten. Look for both explicit and implicit ways the author makes a point. In other words, look for ways the author conveys ideas through both "showing" and "telling."

• EXTRA HELPING

The poet Dudley Randall wrote a poem about the debate between Washington and Du Bois.

∞ Link: Booker T. and W.E.B.

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Recollect the scene in which Prospero draws a charmed circle with his staff. What does he say to those brought into the circle?

→ INTRO

Many consider The Tempest Shakespeare's final work. Therefore, Prospero's farewell is often double-read as Shakespeare's farewell to the audience. Before reading the scene, watch Prospero's epilogue.

∞ Video Link: Prospero's Epilogue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.157-171 "Sweet lord" - "indulgence set me free."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

EPILOGUE p.169 & 171

- Why do you think Shakespeare chose to end the play with Prospero asking for the audience's "indulgence" (approval)?

→ READ & DISCUSS

If time permits, read the article on the epilogue.

∞ Article Link: Epilogue

• EXTRA HELPING

The resolution of The Tempest is very complex. To help students connect the dots, have students play this review game. Students will be asked to fill in the quote, find answers, and escape the island!

∞ Link: Escape the Island Game

Literature: Grade 12

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Term 1

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
History of Lit. Readings

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Exams

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Poetry Readings

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Count of Monte Cristo

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exams

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Crescent Moon

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
OR
Up from Slavery & The Souls of Black Folks

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Tempest



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Ralph Waldo Emerson

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

For the next few weeks, we will meet a selection of American writers and poets who were active in the mid-to-late nineteenth century, around the years 1840-1876. As an introduction, Long has a helpful overview of the characteristics of the literature written during this period.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.14-15 "We have noted the significant fact" - "consider an age of poetry."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Biography of Ralph Waldo Emerson

- Do you recognize some of the names of writers who influenced Emerson and who admired him in turn?

2. Spend some time exploring poems written by Emerson, or read excerpts from his famous essay "Self-Reliance" (you probably won't have time to read the whole thing during this lesson time, but you could come back to it later).

∞ Link: Poems by Emerson

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.16-22

- What does non-conformity mean to Emerson? How does he describe it?
- What does Emerson mean by "Trust thyself: every heart vibrates to that iron string"?
- How would you describe Emerson's language and imagery in "Self-Reliance"? What does it remind you of?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

Lightning Dreamer

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the orphan theater?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-70

- What was Manuel's concern in this chapter? Is it for Tula? Or himself?
- How does reading about injustice differ from actually experiencing it for Tula?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Why do you think Caderousse was Dantès's first stop? What can Dantès do in disguise that he wouldn't be able to do if he revealed his true self to his former friends and acquaintances?
- Continue to add to your character list.



Term 2

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

Lightning Dreamer

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What injustice does Tula experience in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-90

- Has your impression of Tula's mother changed at all throughout the story?
- Do Manuel's actions change your perception of him? How has he supported Tula throughout the story?

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare the concerns of Tula, Manuel, Caridad, Mama, and the Nuns in p.73-83.

Are they justified or not, given the time and setting?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The tertulias brought people together in quiet defiance. They were often political rebellion disguised as parties; a way of sharing counterculture ideas in places where fascist regimes had made it dangerous, even illegal, to gather.

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Orient yourself a bit more to Jane Eyre.

→ NOTE

This book is too long to finish in the term, just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time, or if you are interested, finish it after the end of the term.

→ READ

p.3 "Introduction to the Author" and p.10 "Background of the Work"
Ch.1 p.32-39

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- The first sentence of this novel is the famous: "There was no possibility of taking a walk that day." What is evoked by this sentence? What does it assume, deny, or allude to?
- View question #2 or #3 on p.263 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: JAMES)

Percival Everett described his novel James as a conversation with Mark Twain's *The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*, where events from Twain's novel are reimagined from the perspective of Jim, the runaway slave. It won the Pulitzer Prize in 2025, and the committee described it as "an accomplished reconsideration of *Huckleberry Finn* that gives agency to Jim to illustrate the absurdity of racial supremacy and provide a new take on the search for family and freedom."

→ NOTE

This book is too long to finish in the term, just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time, or if you are interested, finish it after the end of the term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.1 p.9-20

- What do we learn about the character of James in this opening chapter?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See Planning & Prep for content considerations.



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How are his two manners of speaking connected to his identity?

- What is the first interaction like between James and Huck?

2. ∞ Link: Huckleberry Finn Chapter 2 opening scene

- What do you notice reading these two scenes back to back? How does Percival Everett reimagine the scene from Huckleberry Finn? Which details does he keep, and what does he change? What is the overall effect?

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Henry IV Part 2 is a tale about Prince Hal falling into his father's footsteps as king. Hal's life will no longer be the same when he feels the weight of the crown. Henry IV Part 2 is actually the third play in a tetralogy. The Henriad is all about Henry becoming the warrior king. Let's take time to review the first 6 slides on the Henriad plays to better understand the play.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Induction - Act 1 Scene 1 p.7-25 "Open your ears," - "yet more need."

- What role do you think Northumberland will play in this story?

★ TEACHER TIP

Refresh yourself, if desired, on Shakespeare's plays and biography to share "by the way," especially the section on how Shakespeare structures his histories. Remember to read the summaries before a scene to help orient students and explore retellings if desired.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

Henry David Thoreau

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What stood out most to you in reading about Emerson last week?

→ INTRO

Another Transcendentalist writer who was strongly influenced by Emerson was Henry David Thoreau. As you read today, see if you recognize similar themes and concepts from what you read last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Biography of Henry David Thoreau

2. "Solitude" from Walden

You will be working on making an outline of Thoreau's essay today and in Composition. As you read, list the main ideas/phrases or summarize sections.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.23-30

- How does Thoreau differentiate between being alone and loneliness? Why, according to him, can people be lonely even when they are with others?
- What does this reading tell us about how Thoreau relates to nature?
- Which aspects of Thoreau's views on solitude are most relevant today? Do you think that modern society still values solitude? What has perhaps made it harder to be alone in the way Thoreau describes?



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WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

Lightning Dreamer

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What risks were Tula and Manuel taking in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-109

- How does Tula learn to hide her messages?
- What are some of the acts of defiance and courage in the book so far, and what are their consequences?
- Why does Mama imagine their lives will be peaceful and prosperous once Tula is married? Do you think she's right?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 27

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What are some of the themes that you recognize in the novel so far? Does it remind you of any other books you have read?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

Lightning Dreamer

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-127

- Why can't Tula write even though she now has a degree of freedom with her Uncle gone?
- Why does Tula leave the plantation even though she's now left alone there?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 28

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

How was Jane's "nature" (her personality) portrayed in chapter one, and what role does it have in the plot so far?

→ INTRO

Keep the idea of the quest in mind while reading the novel. What is Jane's quest? What is she looking for? Is what she wants the same as what she needs?

→ READ

Ch.2-3 p.40-63

• COMPOSITION

How does the scene in the red room reflect Gothic literature? (Elements of Gothic literature include mystery, death, the supernatural, gloom and doom, and horror.) Notice details such as the secret drawer in the wardrobe, the jewel-casket, and parchment, along with words such as spell, secret, blood, and chill. Does the scene become too unrealistic to be believable, or does Brontë succeed in making it realistic?



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→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- What is the significance of the first words of chapter 2 in terms of Jane's development of her sense of self?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What are your first impressions of the character of Jim?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.21-32

- What do you learn about language in this section? How does it contribute to the irony of the novel?

→ VIEW

Understanding Everett's aims and vision for James as you begin the novel will serve as a helpful guide as you read through it.

∞ Video Link: Giving "James" a Voice: Percival Everett on his Reimagining of Huck Finn

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

📄 Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

While Shakespeare's plays are rooted in history, there are differences in the historical characters. Let's review the historical Prince Henry slide together.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scenes 2-3 p.27-49 "Sirrah, your giant," - "time bids begone."

- What is Falstaff's relationship with money and fame? Put this quote by him into your own words: "I can get no remedy against this consumption / of the purse. Borrowing only lingers and lingers / it out, but the disease is incurable" (lines 242-244).

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Henry David Thoreau, cont.

📄 Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What stood out most to you reading about Thoreau last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Today, we will read another chapter from Thoreau's *Walden*. Read as much of it as you can in 20 minutes - if interested, you can always finish it another time. As you read, think about the care Thoreau takes with observation and attention to the natural world around you. How does it compare to other nature studies you have read in the past?

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.31-40

"Spring" from *Walden*

- What aspects of nature become symbolic to Thoreau? What do they

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represent to him?

- What message about life and renewal do you think Thoreau most wants readers to take from “Spring”?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

Lightning Dreamer

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What was plantation life like for Tula with her Uncle gone?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-144

- What happens when some of Tula's fantasies about love meet reality?
- What things do Sab and Tula have in common despite their differences? What insights does Sab's godmother give them?

• COMPOSITION

Explore how Sab and Tula are reflections of each other's freedom dreams. How are their dreams alike? Different?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What are your thoughts on the pacing of the narrative? Remember that The Count of Monte Cristo was originally published in installments. Do you think that format dictated any elements of the narrative?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

Lightning Dreamer

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you remember of Sab's story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.145-159

- Why do you think Tula finally reads her verses in public?
- What do you think will happen after Manuel tells Tula what Mama has planned?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What happened last time as Jane recovered from the red room?

→ READ

Ch.4 p.64-86 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: About The Brontes



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your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #7 or #8 on p.264 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What stood out to you the most from the last reading? What questions do you have at this point in your reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-6 p.33-52

- Why do you think James is helping and protecting Huck when doing so puts him in danger?
- Why is James drawn to reading Enlightenment thinkers such as Voltaire, who wrote about freedom and equality while also espousing racist views? What does his fever-dream debate with Voltaire tell us about James's views and self-education?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ RECAP

Reread Act 1, Scene 3 lines 121-130. What insight do these lines give us into the characters of King Henry IV and Prince Hotspur (Percy)?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 1-2 p.53-75 "Master Fang," - "Follow me, Ned."

- If you were friends with Falstaff, what advice would you give him?

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Walt Whitman

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

When Ralph Waldo Emerson first read Walt Whitman's collection *Leaves of Grass*, he wrote the following in a letter: "I find it the most extraordinary piece of wit and wisdom that America has yet contributed. I am very happy in reading it, as great power makes us happy. [. . .] I greet you at the beginning of a great career, which yet must have had a long foreground somewhere, for such a start. I rubbed my eyes a little, to see if this sunbeam were no illusion; but the solid sense of the book is a sober certainty. It has the best merits, namely, of fortifying and encouraging."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Whitman's Biography

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.41-43

- Which excerpts stood out to you the most? Which images were most striking or unusual?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Walt Whitman Revolutionised American Poetry

→ READ (OPTIONAL)

If you have extra time, you can look up and read some of the poems cited in today's reading, although you will have a chance to read some of Whitman's poetry this week in the Poetry Reading course.

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WEEK 4 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

Lightning Dreamer

☐ Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What happened when Tula went to the city to live?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.160-167 & p.175-179

- We are told why Tula is fleeing to Spain. Why do you think Manuel is joining her? Does this contradict Tula's thoughts that men are freer than women?
- What has Tula learned about love during the book?

WEEK 4 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 31

☐ Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Consider the character of Dantès/The Count. Do you recognize any of the traits he possessed at the beginning of the novel? Or did his time in prison transform him into a completely different person? Have you disapproved of any of his actions so far?

WEEK 4 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

Walt Whitman

→ INTRO

If you are taking the History of Literature course, you will have already met Walt Whitman this week, an unconventional poet influenced by Transcendentalist ideas who wrote in a style all his own.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: Walt Whitman Poems

You will have more time next class to read whichever poems you do not have time to read today. Be sure to look at the discussion questions on the last page.

- What themes do you recognize in Whitman's poems? Which one did you enjoy the most?

WEEK 4 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 32

☐ Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

In the last chapter, Jane was to be sent to Lowood Institution. Tell back what you remember.

→ READ

Ch.5 p.86-105 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to



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either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #9 or #10 on p.264-265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

Tell back what you remember about why James is on the run and why it is so much more dangerous for him with Huck along.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-10 p.53-70

- Reread what James wrote on p.55. He has never had the opportunity to write before: why do you think these are the words he composes first?
- Why does James not agree to go across the river to Illinois?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 3-4 p.77-95 "I pray thee," - "at your belly."

- What do you think is Northumberland's motive to join the rebellion?

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Emily Dickinson

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

You may have read or heard Emily Dickinson's poetry before, since many of her poems are anthologized for children, including "Hope is a Thing with Feathers" and "A Bird Came Down the Walk." However, behind their simplicity is often an enigmatic deeper meaning. Today, we will learn more about her life and work.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Great Women Authors: Emily Dickinson
∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.41-56

- What were some of the major themes of Dickinson's work? How did her unconventional life influence her writing?

2. The Creative Years - a closer look at Dickinson's correspondence with Higginson.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.57-61

You can read two of the more famous letters at the links below:

- ∞ Link: Dickinson Letter 260
- ∞ Link: Dickinson Letter 330

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Finding Emily Dickinson in the power of her poetry

• COMPOSITION - Poetry

Try writing a poem about one of your readings (or rewrite a narration) in Short Meter (four-line stanzas with a 6-6-8-6 syllable pattern). This is a common meter for hymns, and a favorite one of Emily Dickinson (See "A Bird came down the Walk")

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

Walt Whitman, cont.

→ RECAP

Which Whitman poem from last class do you remember the best?

→ INTRO



Term 2

Have you come across the term "elegy" in your study of poetry so far? An elegy is a melancholy, reflective lyric poem written to commemorate the death of a person or any other type of loss. Typically, these poems contain lament, praise, and then often turn to consolation. "When Lilacs Last in the Dooryard Bloom'd" is an elegy written by Whitman after the death of Abraham Lincoln. After Lincoln's assassination, his body travelled the 1600 miles from Washington, DC to Illinois.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: [When Lilacs Last in the Dooryard Bloom'd](#)

- What elements of elegy do you recognize in this poem? How is the poem structured? Can you trace the themes that develop over the sixteen sections?

Continue reading any of the poems from the collection last class.

∞ PDF Link: [Walt Whitman Poems](#)

- What themes do you recognize in Whitman's poems? Which one did you enjoy the most?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 33

📖 Materials: [The Count of Monte Cristo](#)

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Review your character list: what early opinions about some of the characters are you beginning to change? Take some time to add to your notes about characters if you are behind.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

Emily Dickinson

→ INTRO

If you are taking the History of Literature course, you will have met Emily Dickinson this week, who was largely unknown in her own time period, since little of her work was published, but she has become widely read and respected since the publication of her work after her death.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: [Emily Dickinson Poems](#)

Choose some poems by Dickinson to read today. If you get stuck, there are helpful tips for reading in Extra Helpings.

- What themes do you recognize in Dickinson's poems? Which one did you enjoy the most?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: [Tips for Reading Emily Dickinson's Poetry](#)

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 34

📖 Materials: [Jane Eyre](#) or [James](#)

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What is Lowood Institution like so far?

→ READ

Ch.6-7 p.105-129 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.



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→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #11 or #12 on p.264-265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your reading last week about the relationship between Huck and James?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11-15 p.71-92

- Why is reading such a dangerous act? Why does James want to hide it from Huck? What realization does he have about the power of reading?
- What are some examples of irony that you have come across so far? Irony can be verbal (characters saying the opposite of what they mean), situational (the opposite of what one might expect happens), or dramatic (the reader/audience knows more than the character).

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Have you ever been given a responsibility that you didn't want? Or maybe the task you were given made you nervous? In the clip we're about to watch, we see how being a king is a big responsibility.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 4 - Act 3 Scene 1 p.95-115 "Have you turned" - "the Holy Land."

- How do we see the weight of the crown affecting King Henry?
- Put this quote by King Henry into your own words: "Uneasy lies the head that wears a crown ... O God, that one might read the book of fate / And see the revolution of the times / Make mountains level, and the continent, / Weary of solid firmness, melt itself / Into the sea" (lines 31; 45-49).

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

Emily Dickinson, cont.

→ RECAP

Which of Dickinson's poems, that you read last class, did you enjoy the most?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose some other poems by Dickinson to read today from a different online resource. There are links below to some of her most well-known poems.

∞ Link: Poems by Emily Dickinson



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- ∞ Link: I Dwell in Possibility
- ∞ Link: A Bird Came Down the Walk
- ∞ Link: Hope is the Thing with Feathers
- ∞ Link: There is no Frigate like a Book

- What themes do you recognize in Dickinson's poems? Which one did you enjoy the most?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Which character are you enjoying reading about the most? Which character the least? Why?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

The Aeneid - Preparation

→ INTRO

Before you begin reading The Aeneid next class, spend today getting acquainted with the text. Look at the glossary of characters at the back, which you will refer to often. Begin reading the first thirty lines or so to get a feel for the language.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This helpful introduction to the Aeneid should give you a clear overview of the context of the epic and the general plot before we dive into the poem itself. You can read it today (skip the three exercises) and refer to it as you are reading the poem if you feel stuck.

∞ Link: Introduction to Virgil's Aeneid

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 36

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Tell what you remember about Jane's friendship with Helen Burns.

→ READ

Ch.8-9 p.130-153 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #13 or #14 on p.265 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-19 p.93-113

- What does having a pencil mean to James? What did the risk cost

• COMPOSITION

Helen's moving deathbed scene is a central moment in Jane's life, in her faith, and in her development as a character. Write about the literary, emotional, and theological significance of this scene.



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George, and how does this change James's relationship with the pencil?

- What does James mean when he writes, "With myself I wrote myself into being. I wrote myself to here."? How does this reflect back on Everett's vision for his novel?
- Soon after James writes these words, there is a retelling of a scene from *Huckleberry Finn* when Jim and Huck reunite, and Huck witnesses the feud between the Harney and Grangerford families. If you are familiar with Twain's novel, how does Everett adapt this story into his own?

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Before reading the scene, let's watch a famous monologue from Falstaff called "The Chimes at Midnight." Keep in mind that Falstaff is about to lead a regiment into war.

∞ Video Link: The Chimes at Midnight

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 2 p.117-137 "Come on, come on," - "there an end."

- What do you think the chimes of midnight mean?

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

The Victorian Period

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

The close of the Romantic Period is commonly marked by the death of Sir Walter Scott in 1832, and the remainder of the nineteenth century in British Literature is referred to as the Victorian Period, named for Queen Victoria, who reigned from 1837-1901. Literature written during this period often focused on social issues, the changes wrought by the Industrial Revolution, the effects of discoveries in science, and a concern for morality. This was also the period that saw the rise in popularity of the novel.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Victorian Period" p.62-73

- Where do you see elements and concerns of the Victorian Period still present in our culture today?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37

The Aeneid - Introduction

Materials: The Aeneid

→ INTRO

What do you know about an "epic" – what are the connotations of the word more broadly, and what do you know about epics in literature? Name any you have read and what you remember about epic conventions.

Virgil's *Aeneid* is an epic that owes much to Homer's two books, *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey*, which you may have already read in part or as a retelling. Chronologically, the story of *The Aeneid* picks up where *The Iliad* left off - with the fall of Troy - but Virgil lived 700-800 years after Homer, in Rome rather than Greece, and in a very different world. During Virgil's lifetime, the Roman Republic was coming to an - at times violent - end, and amid this uncertainty, Virgil looked backwards and chose the beginning of Rome as his epic subject: following the Trojan Aeneas from the destruction

- COMPOSITION - Compare/Contrast Compare *The Aeneid*'s opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey*.
- ∞ PDF Link: *Iliad* Opening Lines
- ∞ PDF Link: *Odyssey* Opening Lines
- How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?



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of Troy to the founding of a new city.

C.S. Lewis, in his Preface to *Paradise Lost*, saw epics like the *Iliad*, *The Odyssey*, and *Beowulf* as "Primary Epics": they are works written down after a long tradition of oral storytelling, and they tell the story of heroic deeds in order that such deeds may be remembered. They are myth-making stories, far more concerned with the life of one hero - Achilles, Odysseus, *Beowulf* - than with the wider historical context. However, Lewis argues that something new happens with Virgil, and the *Aeneid* is the earliest example of a "Secondary Epic": "one of the most important revolutions in the history of poetry." In *The Aeneid*, Lewis writes, Virgil "decides to take one single national legend and treat it in such a way that we feel the vaster theme to be somehow implicit in it. He has to tell a comparatively short story and give us the illusion of having lived through a great space of time. He has to deal with a limited number of personages and make us feel as if national, or almost cosmic, issues are involved. He must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 1-96 "Wars and a man I sing" - "King of Cloudbursts."

- Today is a short reading to allow you time to look up characters in the Pronouncing Glossary, p.424-484, and begin to make a character list, if you would find that helpful.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 37

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Reflect back on what you have read so far. What do you think of the pacing of the plot? Is it uneven? Too fast or slow? Would you describe the novel as a "page turner"? Is there a scene that you think would be a compelling scene in a play?

- COMPOSITION - Script
Choose a scene you have read so far in *The Count of Monte Cristo*, and rewrite it as a script for a play or movie.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading? How does Virgil open his epic?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 97-367 "With such thanks" - "the men of Troy."

- What have you learned so far about the Aeneas's character? Why do you think he "assumes a look of hope / and keeps his anguish buried in his heart?"

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 38

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What do you think will happen next in the story?

→ READ

Ch.10 p.153-169 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10



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minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- What does it tell us about Jane that it takes Miss Temple's departure, rather than her own ambition, to push her toward a new life? Is she being passive, or is there something else going on?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from last week about the introduction of the Duke and the King?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-22 p.114-132

- What happens at the revival?
- Why are James and Huck in so much more danger once they cross paths with the Duke and the King?
- If you know Twain's original story, discuss how Everett is adapting it with these episodes.

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 1 p.141-167 "What is this" - "yielder-up of breath."

- Who is John of Lancaster? What were some skills he demonstrated in the scene?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students draw two circles. Have them label one "Sir John Falstaff," and the other "Prince Hal." From there, list other characters who are related or have a significant relationship with those two characters.

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Charles Dickens

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

You have likely already read a novel or two by Charles Dickens, but even if you haven't, characters like Scrooge and Oliver Twist, or lines such as "It was the best of times, it was the worst of times," have become familiar adages. Today, you will learn more about his life and work

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXIV "Dickens - Smiles and Tears"

- What do you notice about Dickens' style in the passages quoted here?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 367-595 "But Aeneas, duty-bound" - "who dares to battle men."

- What have you learned so far about the gods? How do they interact

- COMPOSITION - Descriptive
Try writing your own epic simile.
It can be in prose or verse.



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with mortals?

- Why do you think Venus comes to Aeneas in disguise?
- Why does Aeneas have such an emotional reaction when he sees images of the Trojan War displayed in Carthage?

→ CLOSE READING

- 517-528: This is an example of an epic simile, which is an extended comparison. Here, Virgil compares workmen making a theater to the labor of bees. Why is this a striking comparison?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 39

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think the novel is trying to say about the relationship between revenge and justice? If Dantès had acted differently, do you see a way that he could have sought justice and cleared his name?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 596-908 "And now / As Trojan Aeneas" - "and seas on earth."

- Why does Venus send Cupid disguised as Ascanius? Do you think Venus is trying to protect Aeneas, manipulate the situation, or both?
- Is Dido responsible for her eventual feelings for Aeneas if the gods interfere so heavily? What early signs in this passage hint that the relationship between Dido and Aeneas may become tragic?
- How much free will do mortals seem to have in the epic? This is a question to come back to as you read further.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Aeneas's son is called both Ascanius and Iulus.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 40

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Tell about Jane's reunion with Bessie in the last chapter.

→ READ

Ch.11 p.169-193 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #17 on p.265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)



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What did you learn in last week's reading about Huck's mother? Why doesn't James feel free to speak to Huck about her?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23-25 p.133-148

- How is the relationship between James and Huck beginning to change?

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

The real-life Henry IV had health problems that Shakespeare hints at in the play. Let's review slide 13 to see how the king's health decline plays a role in the story.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scenes 2-3 p.167-187 "What's your name," - "(Softly, pray.)"

- How has Hal and his father's relationship changed throughout the series? Do you think King Henry believes his son can be king?

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Christina Rossetti

→ INTRO

You may have already heard some of Christina Rossetti's work in the Christmas carol "In the Bleak Midwinter" or the well-loved poem for children "Caterpillar (Brown and furry)," but today you will learn more about her life and work, and the deep Christian piety that lies behind some of her most well-known works.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Christina Rossetti: A Woman for All Seasons

- What other writers or themes common in nineteenth-century literature does Rossetti remind you of?

→ VIEW

If you have extra time, listen and read the lyrics to "In the Bleak Midwinter."

∞ Video Link: In the Bleak Midwinter

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 1-255 "Silence. All fell hushed" - "nor all the thousand ships."

- Have you heard the phrase "beware the Greeks bearing gifts" before? Why do you think it has become an adage?
- Why do you think Virgil chooses to recount the fall of Troy through the narrative of Aeneas rather than directly? How do you see Aeneas's emotion shaping the story he tells?
- What role does Sinon play in this section?



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WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 41

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42

Christina Rossetti

→ INTRO

If you are taking the History of Literature course, you will have met the English writer Christina Rossetti this week, who wrote devotional, lyrical, and romantic poetry, and who is closely associated with the Pre-Raphaelites, a school of artists and writers with Christina's brother Dante as one of its central members.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Christina Rossetti poems

Choose some poems by Rossetti to read today. Some suggestions:

∞ Link: Caterpillar

∞ Link: Who Has Seen the Wind?

∞ Link: Remember

∞ Link: Echo

- What themes do you recognize in Rossetti's poems? Do they remind you of anything else you've read this term? Which one did you enjoy the most?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 42

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What happens when Jane arrives at Thornfield Hall?

→ READ

Ch.12 p.193-208 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #18 on p.265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you remember from last week about James's interaction with Easter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-29 p.149-169

- How is James being sold to Emmett so that he can sing with the Virginia



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Minstrels an example of irony?

- What do you think of the character of Emmett? Do you think he is trustworthy?

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

As we have seen, the relationship between Prince Hal and King Henry is complicated. In the clip we will watch, we will see how the crown complicates the relationship between the father and son.

∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 3 p.187-203 "Let there be" - "shall Harry die."

- Why is King Henry mad at Prince Hal?
- Put this quote from the scene into your own words:

"No, I will sit and watch here by the King.
Why doth the crown lie there upon his pillow,
Being so troublesome a bedfellow?
O polished perturbation, golden care,
That keep'st the ports of slumber open wide
To many a watchful night!"

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Matthew Arnold

→ INTRO

In an 1890 edition of The Parents' Review, Charlotte Mason wrote: "The happy phrase of Mr. Matthew Arnold—which we have appropriated as the motto of the Parents' Review—is, perhaps, the most complete and adequate definition of education we possess. It is a great thing to have said, 'Education is an atmosphere, a discipline, a life.'" Now, no one, including Mason herself, has been able to track down exactly where Arnold said this, but his influence on Mason's educational philosophy can be found throughout her writings. Today we will learn more about this school inspector, educational theorist, poet, cultural critic, and father of the genre we now call literary criticism.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Arnold's Biography

∞ Article Link: Biography of Matthew Arnold

2. Arnold's most famous poem

∞ Link: Dover Beach

- Where do you see some of the major themes of nineteenth-century literature and thought in this poem?

3. Arnold's Criticism

Arnold believed that the critic's job was to "know the best that is known and thought in the world." You do not have time today to read this whole work, but reading a few minutes of Arnold's Study of Poetry will give you a feel for this genre.

∞ Link: The Study of Poetry



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WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 256-501 "But a new portent" - "they know so well."

- Can you find epic similes in this section? Why do you think there are so many of them in battle scenes?
- What is the significance of Aeneas dreaming of Hector's ghost? What message does Hector have for Aeneas?
- Why does Aeneas keep fighting even once it is clear that Troy is lost?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 43

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Since The Count of Monte Cristo was published in the mid-1840s, there has been a debate about what type of book it is. Some have seen it as a literary masterpiece, while others argue it is a precursor to popular pulp fiction. Do you have an opinion one way or another? Can you find examples that support and refute both sides of the debate?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44

Catch-up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 44

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

How did Jane meet Mr. Rochester?

→ NOTE

This week is a longer reading. You can split this lesson between two days this week, or read some in your free time.

→ READ

Ch.13-14 p.209-244 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- Why do you think Brontë introduces Rochester as someone who breaks the rules of polite behavior? How does Jane's refusal to defer to him set



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up their relationship as something different from the typical governess-employer dynamic?

Do you find Rochester sympathetic at this point in the novel, or does something about him make you uneasy?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from last week about the members of the Virginia Minstrels?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30-Part 2 Ch.1 p.170-196

- Why do you think it is at this stage of the story that James is beginning to experience some new, complicated feelings - "a good bad feeling," he calls one of them (176)?
- What do you think of the songs Emmett writes? Why does James think they need to be part of his story? (All the songs are included as a preface to the novel; if you want to review them.)
- What has the pencil come to mean to James?

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Let's take a few minutes to recall key events. Create a list or a series of stick-figure drawings of some of the most important scenes in Henry IV Part 2.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scenes 1-2 p.207-223 "By cock and pie," - "life one day."

- How would you describe Falstaff's relationship with Henry? Do you think Henry can remain friends with Falstaff?

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Alfred Lord Tennyson

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

William Long writes of Tennyson: "Though the Victorian age is notable for the quality and variety of its prose works, its dominant figure for years was the poet Tennyson. He alone, of all that brilliant group of Victorian writers, seemed to speak not for himself but for his age and nation; and the nation, grown weary of Byronic rebellion, and finding its joy or sorrow expressed with almost faultless taste by one whose life was noble, gave to Tennyson a whole-souled allegiance such as few poets have ever won." And he goes on, "There is a wide variety in Tennyson's work: legend, romance, battle song, nature, classic and medieval heroes, problems of society, questions of science, the answer of faith, — almost everything that could interest an alert Victorian mind found some expression in his poetry." Today, you will learn more about his life and work, and will read his well-known poem Ulysses, if you are taking the Poetry Reading course.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. LXXXV "Tennyson - The Poet of Friendship"

- What images and excerpts included in this chapter stood out to you?



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WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 501-725 "But oh / how wrong to rely" - "bow to my commands."

- Why is Priam's death such a turning point in the fall of Troy? What details does Virgil include to make it particularly tragic?
- What is Aeneas's reaction to Priam's death?
- Why does Venus appear at that moment, and what is her message to Aeneas?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 45

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- At whatever point you are at in the novel, think about how you would describe Dantès/The Count of Monte Cristo. Is he the hero of the story? Is he a tragic anti-hero figure, like a good guy gone wrong? Or is he an outright villain?
- Several weeks ago, you reflected on the relationship between revenge and justice. Today, consider the question of morality. What actions taken by Dantès have been moral? Do you see him as fundamentally a moral character, or the opposite?
- Review your character list. How have the characters changed since your first impressions of them?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46

Alfred Lord Tennyson

→ INTRO

If you are taking the History of Literature course, you will have met the English poet Alfred Lord Tennyson this week, a master of blank verse (among other forms), whose poems cover a range of diverse topics, including Arthurian legends, nature, mourning historical events, and the human condition. Today you will read Ulysses, a blank verse (unrhymed lines of iambic pentameter) monologue spoken by the epic hero (also called Odysseus) at the end of his life as he plans for one more journey. If you read the Odyssey last year, you will recognize familiar characters and references.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Ulysses

- How would you describe the speaker? How does he relate to his son (Telemachus) and his wife (Penelope)?
- What do you think the lines "Yet all experience is an arch wherethro' / Gleams that untravell'd world whose margin fades / For ever and forever when I move" mean? Why does that make the speaker feel restless?
- How would you interpret the final line?

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 46

Materials: Jane Eyre or James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

What do you think will happen next in the story?

→ READ

Ch.15 p.244-262 OR Read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- Jane knows her feelings for Rochester are dangerous and tries to talk herself out of them. Why does she distrust her own emotions here, and is she right to?
 - What do we know at this point in the story that Jane doesn't?
 - What images and scenes come to mind when you think of this story? How would you describe it (so far) to someone who had never read it?
-

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your last reading of James?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-5 p.197-217

• COMPOSITION

It was common in this era for women to paint and participate in other ornamental arts. How does Brontë enliven this cliché in using Jane's paintings to reveal her inner psyche and to advance the plot?

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 3 - Epilogue p.223-245 "Nay, you shall" - "bid you good night."

- Why does Henry say he doesn't know Falstaff?

★ TEACHER TIP

Have students review the PBS infographic to help them tie the narrative together.

∞ Link: Henry Part 2 Map

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
History of Lit. Readings

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47

Exams

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Poetry Readings

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Count of Monte Cristo	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48 <i>Exams</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Poetry Readings	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Jane Eyre OR James	
WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Henry IV Part 2	



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WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

Mark Twain

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

You may have already come across Mark Twain and his influence in other literature courses this year. The twentieth-century novelist Ernest Hemingway claimed that "All modern American literature comes from one book by Mark Twain called Huckleberry Finn." What do you already know about Mark Twain, and what have you read?

Today, we will learn more about Twain through his life, his influence worldwide, and through reading a short story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Twain's Biography

∞ Article Link: Biography - Mark Twain

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain - Writer

2. Twain's Influence

∞ Article Link: Mark Twain and World Literature

• Which examples cited in this article were most surprising to you?

3. "Luck" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.74-77

• Where do you find irony in this story? Was it what you expected it would be?

• How reliable is the clergyman as a storyteller?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 725-998 "There / yes, where you see" - "headed toward the mountains."

• Venus shows Aeneas the actions of the gods in the fall of Troy - what does this say about fate and human action?

• Is Aeneas at fault for what happens to Creusa? Why or why not? How is your answer affected by her ghost's final speech?

• Book II ends with Aeneas carrying his father and leading his son. How is this symbolic for the past of Troy and the future of Rome?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 49

"The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

We've included audio versions of these stories as an alternative to reading the written stories. Short stories can be especially fun to hear aloud with a talented narrator, though it will take longer than reading the story.

Mark Twain (1835–1910) is the pen name of Samuel Clemens, one of America's most celebrated writers, who was known for his sharp wit. His most famous works include *The Adventures of Tom Sawyer* and *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*. Published in 1865, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog" was the story that made Twain a household name. The

★ TEACHER NOTE

In the second week of this term, we'll read "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry, which is a Christmas story. Feel free to reschedule this story for closer to Christmas if desired.



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story blends exaggeration and comic timing in a way that was fresh and distinctly American when it was published. As you read, pay attention not just to what happens, but to how the story is told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.2-5 "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain
 ∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What makes Simon Wheeler's way of telling his story just as funny as the story itself? Can you think of another story, movie, or TV show where the delivery matters as much as the punchline?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain bio

WEEK 1 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50

The Aeneid, cont.

□ Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?
- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?
- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:
 ∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 1 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 50

Introduction - Things Fall Apart

□ Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ INTRO

Things Fall Apart by Chinua Achebe tells the story of the Igbo tribe in nineteenth-century Nigeria through the life of Okonkwo, a prominent and proud warrior at the center of his community. The story is divided into three parts: Part 1 depicts Okonkwo's life, family, and the culture of his tribe; in Part 2, Okonkwo has been exiled, and in the intervening seven years, missionaries and colonial administrators have come to the village of Umuofia; and in Part 3, Okonkwo returns to a changed village.

Achebe is careful not to present a romanticized or sanitized representation of the Igbo way of life. This novel is recommended for



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mature students, as it contains scenes of violence, including domestic violence, killings, and ritual practices that are unsettling both to readers and characters within the story.

→ VIEW

The following two videos will provide a helpful, interpretive framework for approaching the novel. Achebe wrote about the importance of having a "balance of stories," and this is a helpful concept to keep in mind as you read the novel.

- ∞ Video Link: Achebe Discusses Africa 50 Years After 'Things Fall Apart'
- ∞ Video Link: Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: The Danger of a Single Story

→ STUDY

These two videos will take up nearly the whole lesson time, but also take a minute to review the Glossary on p.211-212. You will want to consult this list as you read throughout the term.

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Like *The Tempest*, *The Winter's Tale* is not a traditional tragedy or comedy but another tragicomedy. Let's review the elements of tragedies and comedies.

- ∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scenes 1-2 p.7-25 "Archidamus, a Bohemian" - "an honest man."

- Why is Leontes suspicious of Hermione and Polixenes? What does this reveal about his character at the start of the play?

★ TEACHER TIP

Refresh yourself, if desired, on Shakespeare's plays and biography to share "by the way," especially the section on how Shakespeare structures his tragedies and comedies. Remember to read the summaries before a scene to help orient students and explore retellings if desired.

- ∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

The Rise of Newspapers

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

For the remainder of Term 3, we will be looking at a variety of different nineteenth-century topics, genres, and authors from around the world. Today, we will explore the rise of newspapers.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: The Early Nineteenth-Century Newspaper Boom

- What historical factors do you think contributed to the large number of newspapers published in the middle decades of the nineteenth century?

2. The Cherokee Phoenix

The Cherokee Phoenix was the first Indigenous national newspaper, and it published articles in Cherokee as well as English. While it has existed in several different versions since 1828, it is still in print today. Read its initial Prospectus, which outlined the aims and intentions of the newspaper.

- ∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.78-80

- Who was the intended readership of the Cherokee Phoenix? What was its intended purpose? Did any lines or phrases in particular stand out to you?

3. If you have any additional time, explore some of the other newspapers shown in the first link.



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WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ INTRO

Paul Lawrence Dunbar was one of the first Black Americans to earn a living as a writer, and he inspired many other literary giants who would come after him. In fact, "I know why the caged bird sings" (one of the most iconic lines in African American literature and the title of Maya Angelou's autobiography) comes from one of Dunbar's poems. He was the only Black student in his high school and became friends with Orville Wright and his brother Wilbur (who you may remember as the inventors of the airplane). The Wright brothers owned a printing press and published Dunbar's first writings. While Dunbar only lived to age 33, he has been described as "your favorite poet's favorite poet" due to the impact his large body of work had on future writers. Older students may want to read more about Dunbar in extra helpings.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-104 "Author's Note"

p.1-10 "You never heard of" - "could try again."

- Why do you think the book says "it's almost like two different men wrote those two poems"? What are some of the differences both in form and content?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fifth Massachusetts Colored Cavalry

• EXTRA HELPING

For more on Paul Laurence Dunbar, you can read his full biography here:

∞ Link: Paul Laurence Dunbar bio

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 51

"The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter (1862–1910), an American writer famous for his short stories about ordinary people — especially the working poor of New York City. His warm, ironic style made him one of the most popular writers of his era. Published in 1905, "The Gift of the Magi" is perhaps his most beloved story. If you have extra time, his biography (see video link) is especially interesting.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.6-9 "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Were Jim and Della's sacrifices generous or just foolish? Why?
- Where did O. Henry plant clues about the twist ending? Did any of them tip you off while you were reading?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: O. Henry bio

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore



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Extra Helpings.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 52

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What did you find most helpful from the videos last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-3 p.3-25

- How would you describe Okonkwo's relationship with his father, Unoka? How are the two men different from each other? Do you see any ways they are similar?
- Why does Ikemefuna come to live with Okonkwo's family?
- Write a brief character sketch of Okonkwo.

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Let's watch Act 1, Scene 2, and get an understanding of the conflict of the play. King Leontes' jealousy is the basis for the conflict of the play.

Shakespeare uses the word 'cuckholded' to describe adultery. To gain a deeper understanding, consult the Oxford Dictionary.

∞ Video Link: Act 1, Scene 2

∞ Link: Cuckolded Definition

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.25-43 "Camillo, this great" - "Come, sir, away."

- How do Camilo's actions contrast with the kings'? What does this reveal about his character?

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

You may have already come across Edgar Allan Poe's writing or his influence on popular culture. If you are taking the General Literature course, you will begin reading "The Gold Bug," a short story by Poe, around now. Today, you will learn more about his life and works.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Poe's Biography

∞ Article Link: Edgar Allan Poe - Biography

2. An assessment of Poe's writings by William Long.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.81-89

- What are some of the features Long highlights about Poe's writing?

3. If you have extra time today, you can read Poe's most famous poem, "The Raven."

∞ Link: Poe - The Raven



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WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-16 "Little brown baby" - "Come in hyeah, you scamp!"

p.108-110 "Joshua Dunbar" - "for their beauty, as well."

p.17-20 "Matilda Dunbar loved" - "an' say good night."

- Paul Dunbar is acclaimed by literary historians for his innovation and experimentation. Where do you see evidence of that in the poems you are reading?
- Look closely at "When de Co'n Pone's Hot" (p.13-14): can you identify the meter (syllables per line) and a regular rhyme scheme? Is there a pattern? For an even bigger challenge, see if you can identify which syllables in each line are stressed (have more emphasis when you pronounce them). Is this regular, too?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 53

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Edgar Allan Poe (1809–1849) is one of America's most distinctive and influential writers. Poe is known for dark, atmospheric tales of mystery and the macabre. Surprisingly, he also pioneered the detective story! Poe had a fascination with puzzles, codes, and the power of careful reasoning. Published in 1843, "The Gold Bug" is a mystery with a secret message written in code, and cracking it requires sharp eyes and sharp thinking. As you read, pay close attention when the cipher appears and to how the code is broken. If you'd like, see if you can work through it yourself!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.10-17 (stop at "we shall see!")

- How would you describe Legrand and Jupiter from what you've read so far?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Edgar Allan Poe bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Gold Bug" contains a repeated racial slur. Please preview for your students.

If you have already read this story, you may substitute "The Old Nurse's Story" by Elizabeth Gaskell. (Also included in the PDF for this course on p.38-50)

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

After Aeneas leaves Buthrotum, he and his men sail near the land of the Cyclopes and rescue Achaemenides, a Greek who was left behind after Odysseus escaped the Cyclopes Polyphemus in The Odyssey. They then reach Sicily, where Aeneas's father dies, presumably of old age (Book 3,



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lines 818-829). We will pick up the story again with Book 4.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 1-247 "But the Queen" - "piling fuel on his fire."

- How much of what happens in this section is individual choice, and how much is fate controlled by the gods?
- What do you think of Anna's advice?
- Where do you see foreshadowing of tragedy in the way the love story is described?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 54

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the character of Okonkwo from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-5 p.26-45

- What is Okonkwo's family structure? How does his treatment of his family reveal his values and fears?
- Why is Okonkwo afraid of being seen as weak?
- What cultural values are emphasized during the Week of Peace and the Festival of the Yam? What role does the yam play in the economy and life of the village?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading, let's watch a clip from Act 2, Scene 1.

∞ Video Link: Act 2, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 1-2 p.47-67 "Take the boy" - "betwixt you and danger."

- How does Leontes's treatment of Hermione affect those around him, especially Mamillius?

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

Wilkie Collins, the Detective Story, and Sensation Fiction

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

In his biographical sketch of Wilkie Collins (1824-1889), James Sherwood describes him as "a novelist, playwright, and short story writer and the father of the modern English detective novel. Dorothy L. Sayers credited his masterpiece *The Moonstone* as 'probably the very finest detective story ever written'. Though he wrote thirty novels and more than sixty short stories, *The Moonstone* and *The Woman in White* have emerged as giants in the Sensational genre characterized by sinister Italian counts, haunted mansions, abductions, insanity, and mistaken identity."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The article below introduces the work of Wilkie Collins and the emerging Victorian genres of the detective novel and the sensation novel. It also shows how Collins was connected to other writers we have learned about so far this year.

∞ Article Link: Forget Edgar Allen Poe, What About Wilkie Collins? A Tribute to the Forgotten Father of the Detective Novel



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2. Read an excerpt from Collins's novel *The Woman in White* (Chapter 4)
 ∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.90-109

- What do you notice about the style of Collins's writing? Do you recognize elements that seem like clichés now, which were quite new literary devices at the time?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-28 "Now, school" - "had made it possible."

p.110-111 "Central High School" - "Ohio Historical Society, Columbus."

p.29-31 "When Paul commenced" - "Who fought for Uncle Sam."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose not to write in dialect when composing "The Colored Soldiers"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 55

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next during their adventure?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.17-23 "We crossed the creek" - "we had been digging."

- Does the narrator believe Legrand? What does he think has happened to Legrand? Do you agree?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read in the opening of Book 4?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 248-494 "Iarbas - son of an African nymph" - "down upon her bed."

- How does Virgil describe Rumor? What makes Rumor such a powerful force in society and politics?
- What causes Aeneas to decide to leave Carthage?
- Do Dido and Aeneas seem to understand their relationship in the same

★ TEACHER TIP

Sensitive content: preview the opening of today's reading, Book 4, line 248.



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way when they have their final conversation?

- If you have read *The Odyssey*, do you see a parallel in Odysseus's journey with Aeneas's time in Carthage?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 56

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

Where did you leave off in the story last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 p.46-62

- Describe the character of Chielo. She is both a priestess and, in "ordinary life," a woman who works at the market. What does this reveal about Igbo religious beliefs and the roles of individuals?
- How has Ikemefuna begun to change Okonkwo's family? How has he affected Nwoye?
- How is Okonkwo's killing of Ikemefuna a turning point in the novel? Why does he do it when he was forbidden to do it by an elder?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 3 p.67-83 "Nor night nor day" - "upon my bidding."

- What is internal conflict? How does internal conflict within Leontes lead to external conflicts?

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

Jules Verne & Science Fiction

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

Another genre of fiction that became increasingly popular in the nineteenth century was science fiction, although some critics say it took until H.G. Wells at the turn of the twentieth century for science fiction to truly develop. But an undisputed forerunner was the French writer Jules Verne, whom we will learn about today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Jules Verne

∞ Article Link: Biography of Jules Verne

2. Read an assessment of Jules Verne's work and influence on science fiction. (Note: a section of this article in the middle has been omitted for length, so on page # end at "all ends happily," and on the next page (p.#), begin with "To what degree can these four books.")

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.110-117

3. With the time you have left, read the opening to one or both of Verne's most famous novels.

∞ Link: Around the World in 80 Days - opening chapter

∞ Link: Journey to the Centre of the Earth - opening chapters

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul's time in school from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-40 "Door after door closed" - "likely just the way it was."

p.111-112 "The Western Association of Writers" - "ghosts and goblins."

- What images in "Sympathy" stood out to you the most? Does it remind you of anything else you've read this year?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to the poet and author Maya Angelou recite Sympathy.

∞ Video Link: Maya Angelou recites Sympathy

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 57

"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What has happened so far during their adventure, especially while at the tree?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.23-29 "Around the new position" - "place of deposit."

- The narrator immediately demands an explanation rather than simply celebrating when the treasure is found. Why do you think this is?
- We are told very little about who the narrator is. What do you know so far? Why do you think we are told so little?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 494-653 "But Aeneas / is driven by duty" - "Dido says her prayers."

- How many of Aeneas's choices are his own, and how many are dictated by fate and the gods?
- Why does Dido decide that death is her only option?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 58

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS



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Ch.8-9 p.63-86

- What advice does Obierika offer to Okonkwo, either directly or indirectly? How does Obierika view tradition and ritual differently from Okonkwo?
- What does the story of Ezinma and the iyi-uwa reveal about Igbo spiritual beliefs?
- What is the place of women in Igbo culture? Why must they often hide their thoughts and emotions?

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading, let's watch a clip from Act 3, scene 2.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scenes 1-2 p.87-105 "The climate's delicate" - "To these sorrows."

- Act 3 is considered a turning point in the play. What changes do we see in Leontes, other characters, or in the plot?
- Put this quote into your own words: "Hermione is chaste, Polixenes blameless, Camillo a true subject, Leontes a jealous tyrant, his innocent babe truly begotten; and the King shall live without an heir if that which is lost be not found."

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

Literature for Children: Edward Lear & Lewis Carroll

→ INTRO

The nineteenth century also saw the rise of literature written directly for children.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Edward Lear

∞ Article Link: Biography of Edward Lear

2. Poems by Edward Lear

∞ Link: The Owl & The Pussycat

∞ Link: The Jumblies

3. Biography of Lewis Carroll

∞ Link: Lewis Carroll

∞ Link: Poems by Lewis Carroll

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-48 "I don't suppose" - "but who could he share them with?"

- Does the language and style of "The Unsung Hero" remind you of anything else you've read? What images stand out to you the most?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language

Literature: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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and cadence.

Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 59

The Gold Bug by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What "links" of logic has Legrand revealed so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.30-37

- How much of finding the treasure was logic and how much was luck, in your opinion?

• COMPOSITION

"The Gold Bug" is considered an early template for detective fiction. What elements fit that mold? What's missing that later detective stories (such as Sherlock Holmes) add?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 653-876 "The dead of night" - "dissolved in the winds."

- How are Dido's and Aeneas's actions contrasted with each other in this section?
- What details does Virgil include that heighten the tragedy of Dido's death?
- Why does Juno send Iris to Dido?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 60

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Ezinma from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.87-109

- What does the ceremony in chapter 10 show the reader about how law, order, justice, and restitution are handled in Igbo society? What are egwugwu?
- The male ceremony is juxtaposed with a female ritual: Chielo's prophecy and journey with Ezinma to the house of Agbala - how do justice and religion work together to maintain the social order?
- What glimpses of Okonkwo do we see beyond his public persona in today's reading?

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

In this scene, we will encounter a puzzling stage direction: "He exits, pursued by a bear." One question that interpreters ask is, Did they use a real bear? At the time, chained-up bears were used as live entertainment. Many have speculated whether or not the Bard would have used an actual

• EXTRA HELPING

Explore the Royal Shakespeare Company's Create a Bear exercise.

∞ Link: Create a Bear



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bear in a live performance. Since using live bears raises many safety and ethical concerns, artists have since found fun ways to enact this scene. If time permits, read the article from Folgers of the same title as the line to learn more.

∞ Article Link: Pursued by a bear

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 2 p.105-125 "Thou art perfect," - "disguise ourselves."

- Consider the role of fate in the play. Why is Antigonus killed but Perdita spared? Why do you think Perdita is being spared?

- Put this quote into your own words: "Imagine me, Gentle spectators, that I now may be In fair Bohemia. And remember well I mentioned a son o' th' King's, which Florizell I now name to you, and with speed so pace To speak of Perdita, now grown in grace equal with wond'ring...."

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

Alexander Pushkin

→ INTRO

For the final five weeks of the course, we will learn about several writers outside of Britain and the United States. The first is the beloved Russian author Alexander Pushkin, whose folk tale you may have read earlier this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Alexander Pushkin

∞ Article Link: Alexander Pushkin - Biography

2. A selection of poems by Pushkin

∞ Link: If I Walk the Noisy Streets

- Does this remind you of any other poems you read this year?

∞ Link: Poems of Nature

- Read a selection of these poems today with the time you have left.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-56 "But I don't want you to think" - "how deep you dig."

p.112-113 "It would be a shame" - "border of the United States."

p.57-60 "Chicago was behind Paul" - "nuffin' in de pot."

- Why do you think this poem is called a sermon? What is the message of the sermon?

- What does the author mean when she says "Studying a poem isn't like solving a problem in math"?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?



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WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 61

"The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Alexander Pushkin (1799–1837) is Russia's most celebrated and beloved writer, widely considered the father of modern Russian literature. His poetry, novels, and stories established the literary tradition that nearly every Russian writer after him would build upon. Written in 1834, "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" is one of his narrative poems written in the style of a Russian folktale. The story reads like a fairy tale but carries the sharp edge of a fable. As you read, ask yourself who holds the real power in this story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.51-56 "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin
∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What kind of ruler is the king at the beginning of the story, and does your opinion of him change as the story progresses?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Web Link: Alexander Pushkin bio

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 5, Aeneas and the other Trojans leave Carthage and return to Sicily. There, they decide to hold funeral games - including races, boxing, and archery - to honour Aeneas's father Anchises. While the games are going on, the Trojan Women decide to try to burn the ships so that their journey will end there, but Jupiter sends rain to put out the flames. Aeneas is encouraged by the ghost of his father to continue his journey, but those who no longer want to join him are given the option to stay with King Acestes in Sicily.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 6, lines 1-248 "So as he speaks in tears " - "into the vatic Sibyl's shrine."

- How is the Sibyl of Cumae both a prophet and a warning figure? What does she reveal to him about his future?
- Why does Aeneas want to go to the Underworld? What does the Sibyl tell him?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 62

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about ceremonies from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13 p.110-125



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- What does the marriage ceremony reveal about Igbo values?
- What role did Ezeudu play in Okonkwo's story?
- Why does Okonkwo need to be exiled for seven years? And why is his home destroyed by those who "had no hatred in their hearts" against him?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Let's watch a clip and see a 'fool' or a silly person who is mocked and made fun of.

∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 4 p.125-145 "When daffodils" - "Come, strike up."

- In Shakespeare's day, audiences loved foolish characters. There were typically three types of fools:
Natural Fools – Characters who are foolish by nature, often used for humor.
Licensed Fools – Court jesters who are intentionally silly to make others laugh.
Rogue Fools – Tricksters and con artists who use deception to survive.

In The Winter's Tale, Autolycus is the play's fool. What role does Autolycus serve in the play? What type of fool do you think he is?

• EXTRA HELPING

Explore this fun and informative exercise, Act Like a Fool! In Shakespeare's day, audiences loved foolish characters. In The Winter's Tale, Autolycus is the play's fool. In Act Like a Fool, students will try to play the role in the most ridiculous and funny way they can.

∞ Link: Act Like a Fool

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

Leo Tolstoy

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

Today's lesson will introduce you to another Russian author - Leo Tolstoy. If you are taking the General Literature course, you will read one of his short stories this week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Leo Tolstoy

∞ Article Link: Leo Tolstoy - Biography

2. Where Love Is God Is (short story)

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.118-128

- You may not have time to finish this story during the class period, but you can finish it during your free time. It is worth reading until the end!

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-66 "It was time for another book" - "in a broken tongue."

p.114 "In the 1800s" - "member of the family."

p.67-69 "I suppose by now" - "you are welcome, welcome."

- The author writes, "Seems to me that when he started putting together his second book, Paul must have been listening to his heart and his head

• COMPOSITION

How did the hardships of Dunbar's childhood shape him as a writer and a person? Why do you think those same difficulties became a source of strength rather than holding him back?



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both." Which qualities of his poetry do you think come from his heart, and which ones from his head?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 63

"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Leo Tolstoy (1828–1910) is best known for lengthy novels like *War and Peace* and *Anna Karenina*. But Tolstoy was also a master of the short story, and late in his life he turned increasingly toward simple, moral tales. Published in 1886, "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is one of those tales. As you read, watch for how Tolstoy uses one man's desires to build suspense and make his argument.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.57-68 "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- At the end of the story, the title's question is answered. Did the answer surprise you, or did you see it coming? Why?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the *Aeneid* last time?

→ INTRO

Our reading picks up today once Aeneas has entered the Underworld and has seen a number of people whom he knew.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 6, lines 521-554 "And wandering among them" - "pities her as she passes."

- Why do you think Dido does not speak to Aeneas? Who does he blame for her death?

2. Book 6, lines 786-1039 "Now father Anchises" - "the sterns line the shore."

- What does Aeneas's father Anchises show him? Why is this a significant turning point halfway through the epic?

- **COMPOSITION - Persuasive**
Do you think Aeneas is in charge of his own actions, or is he being controlled by fate and the gods? Give reasons from your reading and cite line numbers.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 64

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Okonkwo's exile from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-16 p.129-147

- Why do you think it is important for Achebe to preserve so many



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proverbs by including them in the characters' dialogue? Earlier in the story, we read "Among the Ibo the art of conversation is regarded very highly, and proverbs are the palm-oil with which words are eaten" (7). What do you think this means?

- Describe the character of Uchendu. How does he compare to Okonkwo?

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Act 4, Scene 4 is a challenging scene. One helpful framework to understand the scene is [secret-reveal] or [deception-truth]. Each main character has a secret that must be revealed. While reading, let's ask: What are those secrets? What needs to be revealed? If time permits, let's take a look at Exploring Act 4 in the Extra Helping.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 4 p.145-165 "Pray, good shepherd," - "to die when I desire."

- Contrast Perdita and Florizel's motives at the celebration with Polixenes and Camillo's motives at the celebration. How are they different?
- Put this quote into your own words: "That were I crowned the most imperial monarch... I would not prize [it] without her love" (Act 4, Scene 4, Lines 426, 431).

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more information, take a look at Exploring Act 4.

∞ Link: Exploring Act 4

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

Rosalía de Castro

→ INTRO

The poet we will read today - Rosalía de Castro - was a poet and novelist who is especially remembered for championing the language and culture of Galicia (an autonomous region in northwest Spain with Celtic roots) by choosing to write in Galician rather than Spanish and leading the nineteenth-century Rexurdimento (Galician Revival).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Rosalía de Castro

∞ Article Link: A Few Words About Rosalía de Castro (read only the top section)

2. Explore some of Rosalía de Castro's poems

∞ Link: Translation from Galician to English of 11 poems by Rosalía de Castro

Read the Foreword to *Cantares Gallegos* (1863), then scroll down to find links to the 11 poems. Read the ones that interest you (on each page, you will need to scroll past notes on the translation to find the poems).

→ VIEW

In 2013, bagpipers played in unison across Galicia to commemorate the 150th anniversary of the publication of *Cantares Gallegos*. Watch the musicians playing at the house where de Castro lived.

∞ Video Link: alborada rosalia casa de rosalia

• EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about Galician and see images of the region.

∞ Video Link: Galician Language Guide

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS



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p.69-78 "Majors and Minors" - "a brave man to voice it."
p.114-115 "When Alice's answering letter" - "by Jerome Dowd."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose the tree to recount the story of the murder?
- What are some of the other poems you have read so far by Paul Dunbar that seem to be addressing the racism and inequality described in today's reading?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 65

"The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and philosopher from India who became the first non-European writer to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, receiving it in 1913. He was a prolific writer of poetry, short stories, novels, and plays, and is still considered one of the greatest literary figures of the modern era. His short story "The Kingdom of Cards" is written in the style of a fairy tale and uses an imaginary world to say something true about the real one.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.69-74 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore
∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Would you want to live in the Kingdom of Cards? What does your answer say about what you value?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

We are skipping Book 7 because of time constraints, but in the remaining readings from the Aeneid, you will notice a change of subject matter and style. If the first six books mirror the events of the Odyssey, the final six books mirror the events of the Iliad, with its martial theme.

In Book 7, Aeneas and the Trojans finally arrive in the Italian lands they have been promised by fate. They meet King Latinus, who believes fate has chosen Aeneas to marry his daughter Lavinia, but Juno's fury sets in motion a chain of events that destroys this early peace and sets the stage for war.

Our reading today picks up partway through Book 8, after Aeneas has made an alliance with King Evander, whose son Pallas leads an army to give Aeneas assistance.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 8, lines 717-858 "But the goddess Venus" - "all his children's children."



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- What images does Vulcan forge onto the surface of the shield? Why are they significant at this point in the epic? Does this section help you understand what Lewis means when he argues that Virgil "must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed"?
- This section is another example of ekphrasis: a poetic description of a work of art. How does Virgil draw attention to the sculptural features of the shield? Could this shield actually exist as described, or is it mythical?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 66

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what life is like for Okonkwo's family in exile from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17-19 p.148-167

- How have the missionaries begun to change Mbanta? Why do you think Nwoye is drawn to them?
- Why are others who have been marginalized in Igbo culture drawn to Christianity?
- How does Achebe show both strengths and weaknesses of traditional culture?

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ INTRO

Remember, one helpful framework to understand this scene is [secret-reveal] or [deception-truth]. Keep paying attention to the secrets that still exist and the truth that needs to be revealed.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 4 p.165-191 "Why look you" - "be matter in it."

- Would you ever love someone if it brought conflict to your family or country? How do Florizel's values of love and duty seem to conflict in the scene?

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more information, take a look at Exploring Act 4.

∞ Link: Exploring Act 4

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

E. Pauline Johnson

→ INTRO

Emily Pauline Johnson was born to a Mohawk chief and an English mother, and grew up on the Six Nations Reserve in Ontario. She was educated at home, where she was immersed in both English literary traditions and Mohawk oral storytelling and developed a love for poetry. At a time when Indigenous peoples regularly faced discrimination, she was raised to value her dual heritage. She turned to writing and performing after her father's death to help support her family, traveling across Canada for 17 years. The first half of each of her shows was performed in Indigenous dress and the second half in an English gown, embodying the two cultures that made her who she was. She published her work under both "E. Pauline Johnson" and her Mohawk name, "Tekahionwake."



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→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Pauline Johnson
∞ Article Link: Pauline Johnson - Biography

2. Explore some of Pauline Johnson's Poems
∞ Link: The Song My Paddle Sings
∞ Link: A Cry from an Indian Wife

Explore other poems if you have time
∞ Link: Pauline Johnson Poems

→ VIEW

Learn more about Johnson's story and legacy
∞ Video Link: This Week in History Ep. 17- Pauline Johnson

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-90 "There, now, I guess" - "telling those stories too."
p.116 "Will Marion Cook" - "easy and effortless."

- Why do you think Paul continued to write dialect poems? And why do they remain important to read today, over a hundred years later?
 - Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

- **COMPOSITION - Letter**
Write a letter from Paul to his mother describing his time in England.

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 67

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) was a British writer (born in Edinburgh, Scotland) and best known as the creator of Sherlock Holmes, arguably the most famous fictional detective in the world. He was knighted by King Edward VII in 1902. The Holmes stories defined the modern detective story and have never gone out of print. "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" is widely considered one of the finest Holmes stories ever written. As you read, pay attention to the clues Doyle plants along the way, and see how much you can figure out before he reveals the answer.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.75-85 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle
∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Julia's mysterious dying words are "the speckled band"! Why do you think a dying clue is such a common device in detective fiction?
- Helen has been moved into her dead sister's room because of renovations, and this makes Holmes suspicious. Why do you think Helen herself didn't question it more?

- **COMPOSITION**
Holmes asks Watson to come along to Stoke Moran, warning him there will be danger. Why do you think Watson agrees to come? Is Watson loyal, brave, or does he simply trust Holmes?



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→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Arthur Conan Doyle bio

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 9, Turnus - king of the Rutulians, ally to King Latinus, and suitor of Lavinia - wages a surprise nighttime attack on the Trojans while Aeneas is away. This book describes the ensuing battle, emphasizing the courage and loyalty of the Trojans and the human cost of war.

Today's reading picks up in the middle of a battle and contains many vivid descriptions of violence.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 10, lines 471-774 "Suddenly Pallas runs Rhoeteus through" - "scatter all his triumph."

- Compare Pallas and Turnus. What are their similarities and differences as warriors?
- How does this passage illustrate the human cost of war? One place to look is in the epic similes.
- How are the gods involved in the outcome?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 68

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the coming of missionaries and colonial government agents from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-23 p.171-191

- How has Umuofia changed in the seven years? What is different for Okonkwo when he returns?
- What is the role of education in the work of the missionaries and the colonial government?
- How does Achebe build tension throughout these chapters until the arrests in chapter 23?

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ RECAP

How does the sheep-shearing festival go from a joyful celebration to a moment of crisis for Perdita and Florizel?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.195-213 "Sir, you have" - "good my lord."

- How has Leontes changed from the beginning of the play to this scene? What has caused his transformation?



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WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

Raden Ajeng Kartini

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

The final writer we will meet in this course is Raden Ajeng Kartini, a member of the Javanese nobility in Dutch-controlled Indonesia who was an advocate of women's rights and education in the face of a restrictive caste system. She left behind a large body of writing, including many letters. She only lived to be 25, but was so beloved in her home country that her birthday, April 21, is Hari Kartini, a day in her honor.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Biography of Raden Ajeng Kartini

∞ Article Link: Raden Ajeng Kartini: Indonesia's Feminist Educator

2. Explore some of Kartini's letters which were published in a collection called Letters of a Javanese Princess. These letters give an insight into Indonesian life under Dutch colonial rule, Kartini's familiar and daily life, and her dreams for the future both for herself and for all Indonesian women. Read as much as you can for the remainder of the lesson.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.129-143

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-100 "Now, like I said" - "he'll find you right at home."

- Reflect on what you read about Paul Laurence Dunbar this term. How would you describe his legacy?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

→ VIEW

Take a brief tour of Paul Dunbar's home in Dayton and read about the historic site.

∞ Link: Paul Dunbar House Historic Site

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 69

"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.86-95 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Holmes notices what others ignore. Is that a matter of intelligence, training, habit, or something else entirely?
- Arthur Conan Doyle considered this the best of all his Sherlock Holmes stories. (You can read his top 12 at the link below.) What do you think



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makes it so enduring? How does it compare to Poe's "The Gold Bug" (written almost 50 years prior) as a piece of detective fiction?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: Arthur Conan Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read in the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 11 and at the beginning of Book 12, the two armies pause to bury their dead before the fighting continues. Our final reading from The Aeneid picks up at the final duel between Aeneas and Turnus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 12, lines 916-1113 "Now at the same moment" - "down to the shades below."

- What role do the gods play in this final confrontation?
- Why does Aeneas hesitate? What makes him change his mind?
- What do you think of how the epic ends? Why do you think Virgil decided to end the story with the moment of Turnus's death, rather than with peace and the establishment of Rome?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 70

Materials: Things Fall Apart

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the reading last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24-25 p.192-209

- Was the ending unexpected to you? What do you think of the final paragraph of the book? How does it reflect back on all that has come before?
 - The title of the novel comes from a poem called "The Second Coming" by William Butler Yeats. If you have time, read it and reflect on why Achebe chose it as his title. You may also consider why he chose to write this story in English.
- ∞ Link: The Second Coming

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading the famous scene on Hermione's Statue, let's read an article on the scene and note the lines they cite. While reading, we should feel a sense of magic and enchantment in this scene.

∞ Article Link: Hermione's Statue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scenes 2-3 p.213-235 "Beseech you, sir," - "Hastily lead away."

- How does the final scene tie together the themes of reconciliation and renewal? What characters experienced renewal?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students play the review game The Winter's Tale: Path to Reconciliation.

∞ Link: Winter's Tale: Path to Reconciliation

Watch a clip of Aslan's breath. C.S. Lewis was an English professor and was very familiar with Shakespeare's works. There is an intriguing parallel between The Winter's Tale and The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe. Watch the scene, Aslan's breath,



Term 3

	and see if the students can spot the parallel. Consider, too, how the breath of God is used in Scripture to create life (Gen. 2:7), resurrect the dead (Ezek. 37:9-10), and to impart the Holy Spirit (John 20:22). ∞ Video Link: Aslan's Breath
WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: History of Lit. Readings	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Aeneid	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 71 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Short Stories and Folk Tales	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Jump Back, Paul	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 72 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Things Fall Apart	
WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Literature: Grade 12

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Term 3

Questions will come from:
The Winter's Tale

Literature: Grade 12

Examination

Term 1

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Discuss some of the defining authors and characteristics of the literature written in the first half of the 1800s that we've studied so far. Organize your thoughts into at least two paragraphs.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- The Tempest: Choose one question and give as much detail as possible:
 - What lesson does Prospero learn by the end of the play, and how does it change his actions?
 - Is Caliban justified in his anger toward Prospero? What might motivate Caliban to plot against Prospero?
 - How does Prospero use magic to control the events on the island? Do you think he is fair in his use of magic? Why or why not?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

- Describe the themes and style of the Romantic poets. Either make reference to and compare several of the poets you read this term, or do a deeper reflection on one individual poet.
- Reflect on your reading of Rabindranath Tagore this term. What are some of the major themes in The Crescent Moon? How would you describe his poetry style? Can you compare his work to other poetry you read this term?

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

- Count of Monte Cristo: Describe Edmond Dantès's relationship with Faria; in what ways are they father and son, as Faria claims (72)? How does Faria equip Dantès for his life after prison? OR Write a character sketch of Dantès at the very beginning of the novel, before he is arrested.
- Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass: Explain why reading and literacy were such an important first step in Douglass's path from slavery to freedom. OR Describe some of the ways Douglass's Narrative is such a powerful argument against slavery.

Up from Slavery & Souls of Black Folk: Describe Washington's and Du Bois's differing views on the purpose of education. OR Tell all you know about Washington's early life and how it impacted his future leadership at the Tuskegee school.

Term 2

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Discuss some of the defining authors and characteristics of the literature written in the mid-1800s that we've studied in Term 2. Organize your thoughts into at least two paragraphs.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- Henry IV, Part 2: Choose one question and give as much detail as possible:
 - What struggles does King Henry IV face in this play, and how do they affect his rule?
 - Do you think Prince Hal was ready to be King? Why or why not?
 - How does Prince Hal's relationship with Falstaff change by the end of the play? Why does he make this decision?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

- George Herbert Palmer wrote that "we get used to things and how dull things then become! . . . The genuine poet never grows used to anything." Support or refute this statement with reference to some of the poetry you have read this term.
- Tell or write what you know about Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda and describe one of her poems OR Describe your favorite scene so far from the Aeneid.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

- The Count of Monte Cristo: The final sentence of the novel is: "The count just told us that all human wisdom was contained in these two words: Wait and hope." No matter where you left off in the novel, reflect on how what you have read so far supports this conclusion. OR Write a character sketch of Dantès/The Count of Monte Cristo at the point in the novel where you stopped reading. How has he changed from the beginning of the story?
- Jane Eyre: What are some ways in which Brontë builds mystery and suspense in the first volume? OR What is the basis of the mutual attraction between Jane and Mr. Rochester? Does their attraction seem realistic or romantic? Or both?
- James: Reflect on Percival Everett's use of irony in the novel. Why is this the mode he chooses when telling James's story? OR Discuss the importance of literacy, literature, and writing in the novel. Can you connect it to other books you have read this year?

Term 3

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Describe some of the genres you've studied this term and tell about one particular piece or author you read about with more detail.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- The Winter's Tale: Choose one question and give as much detail as possible:
 - Why does King Leontes wrongly accuse his wife, Hermione, and what are the consequences of his actions?
 - Is King Leontes a good man? Why or why not?
 - How does the story shift from tragedy to comedy? What events make this possible?

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

- Describe what you remember about Paul Laurence Dunbar's life and how it influenced the style and subject matter of his poems.
- Describe the role of the gods and fate in some of the episodes of The Aeneid OR Compare Aeneas to some other epic heroes you have read.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

- Short Stories and Folk Tales: Choose one story from this term that ends with a "twist" and explain how its ending works. What does it reveal? Why is it effective? What do you think the author most wanted you to take away?
OR
Poe's Legrand and Doyle's Sherlock Holmes both solve mysteries through observation and logic, but they are very different kinds of characters. Compare and contrast the two. Which one did you find more compelling and why?
- Readers have often compared the narrative arc of Things Fall Apart to a Greek or Shakespearean tragedy. Using what you know about the genre and conventions of tragedy, would you agree with this? Make reference to specific episodes and characters from the novel. OR Choose one main character from the novel and consider how they change from the beginning of the novel to after the missionaries and colonial government arrive.

